



Soul Food Break*fast



Created By: Dr. D Brown

Foundation in Christ | Adult Edition

SOUL FOOD BIBLE STUDY SERIES

Break · fast - Month 1

Adult Edition

 Theme:

Part I: Prayer, the First Resort

⁶In nothing be anxious, but in everything, by prayer and petition with thanksgiving, let your requests be made known to God. -Phil 4:6 (WEB)

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This book is designed as a Bible study and devotional resource. It is not intended to replace professional counseling, pastoral covering, medical care, or legal/financial advice. Readers are encouraged to seek appropriate professional help when needed and to remain connected to a Bible-believing local church.

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DEDICATION

This work is dedicated first and foremost to the Lord Jesus Christ, the Living Word and true Bread of Life. May every page point back to Him.

To every hungry heart that has ever sat in a pew, at a kitchen table, on a lunch break, or in a quiet corner whispering, “Lord, I want to understand Your Word, but I don’t know where to start”—these lessons were written with you in mind. You are not invisible to God, and you are not too late for His promises.

To the intercessors, pastors, teachers, and destiny helpers who labor in prayer and service behind the scenes: your obedience, your “yes,” and your unseen sacrifices are the soil this work has grown from. May God reward you in ways no book could ever fully acknowledge.

And to every believer who has ever felt like “leftovers on the table of life,” may you discover through these pages that in God’s Kingdom you are never an afterthought. You are the guest of honor at a table He prepared just for you.

With love and gratitude,

Dr. Shefa “Dee” Brown

Creator, SOFU Bible Study Series

QUICK START FOR LEADERS

Who this is for:

Pastors, ministers, small group leaders, Sunday school teachers, and facilitators using the Soul Food Series in any gathering (church, home, online, or community setting).

Session Length & Rhythm

- Recommended session time: 60–75 minutes
- Ideal pace: 1 lesson per week (or biweekly for deeper processing)
- Group size: 4–15 people works best.

Basic Flow for Each Lesson

1. Welcome & Prayer (5–10 min)
2. Appetizer (10–15 min)
3. Main Course: Bites + CST (30–35 min)
4. Dessert & To-Go Box (10–15 min)
5. Closing Prayer (5 min)

Tips for Leading Well

- Create a safe space; remind the group that what is shared stays in the group (w/ appropriate exceptions for safety).
- Honor time by starting and ending close to schedule.
- Let the Holy Spirit lead; the questions are a guide, not a cage.
- Model honesty and vulnerability.
- Invite participation, not performance.

Using Activities & Games

Use Trivia Mix-Up (Millionaire-style) and Tricky Testaments (Jeopardy-style) as openers to review the previous lesson or as closers to reinforce the current one. Let youth or emerging leaders help read questions, track scores, or lead a round to build ownership and confidence.

Before Each Session

- Read the Background Text and lesson in advance.
- (Optional) Play the audio companion track.
- Pray for wisdom, discernment, and sensitivity.
- Ask God who might need extra encouragement that day.

You don't have to be a Bible scholar to lead. You just have to be willing, teachable, and available. God will take care of the rest.

TABLE OF CONTENTS

Breakfast Series

SOUL FOOD BIBLE STUDY SERIES	1
COPYRIGHT.....	3
DEDICATION	4
QUICK START FOR LEADERS	5
TABLE OF CONTENTS.....	6
PROLOGUE.....	11
Introduction – “Prayer, the First Resort”	12
 Breakfast Edition Month 1 – Esther.....	13
Second <i>IS</i> the Best	13
 Appetizer – Instead of, Est 2:17	13
 Main Course — The Call, the Crisis, and the Courage.....	14
 Bite 1 – Mordecai’s Warning, Est 4:13–14	14
 Bite 2 – Fasting Before the Move, Est 4:15–16.....	14
 Bite 3 – The Turnaround, Esther 8:7.....	14
 BM1 — Lesson 2: Solomon	18
 The Question That Unlocked a Legacy.....	18
 Appetizer — When God Says, “Ask Me for Anything”, 1 Kings 3:5–7	18
 Main Course	19
 Bite 1 — Humble Heart of a King, 1 Kings 3:9-10	19
 Bite 2 — God’s Response, 2 Chron 1:11–12.....	19
 Bite 3 — A Legacy That Starts in Prayer, 1 Kings 4:29–30	20
 BM1 — Lesson 3: Jesus	22
 Prayer the First Resort	22
 Appetizer — WWJD: What Would Jesus Do? Luke 5:15–16.....	22
 Main Course – The Mediator and the Model.....	22
 Bite 1 — “Lord, Teach Us to Pray”, Luke 11:1–4.....	22
 Bite 2 — Don’t Quit Praying, Luke 18:1–5	23

 Bite 3 — God Is Not Like the Unjust, Judge, Luke 18:6–8.....	23
 BM1 — Lesson 4 Paul & Silas	26
 Faith in the Dark.....	26
 Appetizer – The Mindset is Everything, Isa 26:3	26
 Main Course – Power in the Praises.....	26
 Bite 1 – The Test in Their Testament, Acts 16:22–24, 31	26
 Bite 2 – The Jailhouse Rocked, Acts 16:25–26.....	27
 Bite 3 – Contagious Praise, Collective Breakthrough, Acts 16:27–30.....	27
SOUL FOOD BIBLE STUDY SERIES	1
COPYRIGHT.....	3
DEDICATION	4
QUICK START FOR LEADERS.....	5
TABLE OF CONTENTS.....	6
PROLOGUE.....	11
Introduction – “Prayer, the First Resort”.....	12
 Breakfast Edition Month 1 – Esther.....	13
Second <i>IS</i> the Best.....	13
 Appetizer – Instead of, Est 2:17	13
 Main Course — The Call, the Crisis, and the Courage.....	14
 Bite 1 – Mordecai’s Warning, Est 4:13–14.....	14
 Bite 2 – Fasting Before the Move, Est 4:15–16.....	14
 Bite 3 – The Turnaround, Esther 8:7.....	14
 BM1 — Lesson 2: Solomon	18
 The Question That Unlocked a Legacy.....	18
 Appetizer — When God Says, “Ask Me for Anything”, 1 Kings 3:5–7	18
 Main Course	19
 Bite 1 — Humble Heart of a King, 1 Kings 3:9-10	19
 Bite 2 — God’s Response, 2 Chron 1:11–12.....	19
 Bite 3 — A Legacy That Starts in Prayer, 1 Kings 4:29–30	20
 BM1 — Lesson 3: Jesus	22

 Prayer the First Resort	22
 Appetizer — WWJD: What Would Jesus Do? Luke 5:15–16.....	22
 Main Course – The Mediator and the Model.....	22
 Bite 1 — “Lord, Teach Us to Pray”, Luke 11:1–4.....	22
 Bite 2 — Don’t Quit Praying, Luke 18:1–5	23
 Bite 3 — God Is Not Like the Unjust Judge, Luke 18:6–8.....	23
 BM1 — Lesson 4 Paul & Silas	26
 Faith in the Dark.....	26
 Appetizer – The Mindset is Everything, Isa 26:3	26
 Main Course – Power in the Praises.....	26
 Bite 1 – The Test in Their Testament, Acts 16:22–24, 31	26
 Bite 2 – The Jailhouse Rocked, Acts 16:25–26.....	27
 Bite 3 – Contagious Praise, Collective Breakthrough, Acts 16:27–30.....	27
 Appendix – Breakfast Month 1 Answer Key	31
Lesson 1 – Esther: Second Is the Best.....	31
Lesson 2 – Solomon: The Question That Unlocked a Legacy	32
Lesson 3 – Jesus: Prayer the First Resort.....	32
Lesson 4 – Paul & Silas: Faith in the Dark.....	33
 Appendix – Breakfast Month 1 Answer Key	31
SOUL FOOD BIBLE STUDY SERIES	1
COPYRIGHT.....	3
DEDICATION	4
QUICK START FOR LEADERS.....	5
TABLE OF CONTENTS.....	6
PROLOGUE.....	11
Introduction – “Prayer, the First Resort”	12
 Breakfast Edition Month 1 – Esther.....	13
Second <i>IS</i> the Best.....	13

	Appetizer – Instead of, Est 2:17	13
	Main Course — The Call, the Crisis, and the Courage.....	14
	Bite 1 – Mordecai’s Warning, Est 4:13–14.....	14
	Bite 2 – Fasting Before the Move, Est 4:15–16.....	14
	Bite 3 – The Turnaround, Esther 8:7.....	14
	BM1 — Lesson 2: Solomon	18
	The Question That Unlocked a Legacy.....	18
	Appetizer — When God Says, “Ask Me for Anything”, 1 Kings 3:5–7	18
	Main Course	19
	Bite 1 — Humble Heart of a King, 1 Kings 3:9-10	19
	Bite 2 — God’s Response, 2 Chron 1:11–12.....	19
	Bite 3 — A Legacy That Starts in Prayer, 1 Kings 4:29–30	20
	BM1 — Lesson 3: Jesus	22
	Prayer the First Resort	22
	Appetizer — WWJD: What Would Jesus Do? Luke 5:15–16.....	22
	Main Course – The Mediator and the Model.....	22
	Bite 1 — “Lord, Teach Us to Pray”, Luke 11:1–4.....	22
	Bite 2 — Don’t Quit Praying, Luke 18:1–5	23
	Bite 3 — God Is Not Like the Unjust, Judge, Luke 18:6–8.....	23
	BM1 — Lesson 4 Paul & Silas	26
	Faith in the Dark.....	26
	Appetizer – The Mindset is Everything, Isa 26:3	26
	Main Course – Power in the Praises.....	26
	Bite 1 – The Test in Their Testament, Acts 16:22–24, 31	26
	Bite 2 – The Jailhouse Rocked, Acts 16:25–26.....	27
	Bite 3 – Contagious Praise, Collective Breakthrough, Acts 16:27–30.....	27
	Appendix – Breakfast Month 1 Answer Key	31
	Lesson 1 – Esther: Second Is the Best.....	31

Lesson 2 – Solomon: The Question That Unlocked a Legacy	32
Lesson 3 – Jesus: Prayer the First Resort.....	32
Lesson 4 – Paul & Silas: Faith in the Dark.....	33
Lesson 1 – Esther: Second Is the Best.....	31
Lesson 2 – Solomon: The Question That Unlocked a Legacy	32
Lesson 3 – Jesus: Prayer the First Resort.....	32
Lesson 4 – Paul & Silas: Faith in the Dark.....	33

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PROLOGUE

“Prayer for Divine Connection”

In the quiet of my heart, I seek Your face,
Elohim, Jesus Christ, fountain of grace.
Through ancient paths where prophets once trod,
I reach beyond the veil to touch my God.

Your Word, a lamp that guides through darkest night,
Transforms my weakness into holy might.
The Holy Spirit breathes where faith is born,
Three persons, one God—Father, Spirit, Son.

In perfect unity, the Trinity divine,
The Comforter within, Your presence mine.
The body of Christ, united as one,
Brother and sister beneath Your sun.

In family ties, both blood and spirit-bound,
Your kingdom's strength on earth is found.
When others stumble, empathy extends my hand,
With sympathy I weep, I pray, I stand.

The Spirit intercedes with groans too deep for words,
An advocate whose whispers always heard.
For we are woven in Your love's design,
Each thread of mercy, wholly Thine.

Through sacrifice You broke sin's heavy chain,
Now in Your presence, I am born again.
The Spirit seals us, marked as heaven's own,
Until we stand before the eternal throne.

-S. L. Doctor

Introduction – “Prayer, the First Resort”

“In nothing be anxious, but in everything, by prayer and petition with thanksgiving, let your requests be made known to God. -Phil 4:6 (WEB)

Before we can truly walk with God, we must first learn to talk with Him. Prayer is not simply a religious routine or a spiritual exercise—it is the first resort that ushers us into a genuine, living relationship with our Creator. From the very beginning, God desired fellowship with humanity, and prayer is the divine pathway through which that fellowship is restored and maintained.



When we pray, we are not informing God of what He does not know; rather, we are inviting Him into the center of our hearts, our situations, and our lives. Prayer is the language of dependence, the heartbeat of faith, and the foundation of intimacy with the Father. It is through prayer that our hearts are softened, our minds are renewed, and our will begins to align with His.

Jesus Himself modeled this truth. Before every major decision, miracle, and moment of ministry, He withdrew to pray (Luke 5:16). His life demonstrated that relationship with the Father was sustained through continual communion. If the Son of God needed prayer to remain connected, how much more do we?

Prayer is not the result of a relationship—it is the beginning of it. It is the open door into knowing God personally, hearing His voice, and walking in His purpose. As we begin this study, let us approach prayer not as a duty but as an invitation—a sacred escort leading us deeper into the presence and love of God.

SOUL FOOD BIBLE STUDY

Breakfast Edition Month 1 – Esther

Second /S the Best

 **Theme:** Prayer, the First Resort

 **Background Text:** Esther 1–4 (focus on chapters 2–4)

 **Key Verse:** Esther 4:14 (WEB)

“For if you remain silent now, then relief and deliverance will come to the Jews from another place, but you and your father’s house will perish. **Who knows if you haven’t come to the kingdom for such a time as this?**”

Appetizer – Instead of, Est 2:17

“The king loved Esther more than all the women, and she obtained favor and kindness in his sight more than all the virgins; so that he set the royal crown on her head, and made her queen instead of Vashti.” --Esther 2:17

Queen Vashti was breathtaking, bold, and unapologetically defiant — so when King Ahasuerus (Xerxes) summoned her to show off her beauty, she refused. Her refusal cost her the crown. A kingdom-wide search began for her replacement. Esther, a Jewish orphan raised by her cousin Mordecai, was chosen and crowned queen — not by luck, but divine placement.

Meanwhile, Haman was promoted, and the king commanded people to bow before him. Everyone complied except Mordecai. His refusal — rooted in the Ten Commandments — enraged Haman, who immediately plotted genocide.

CST Reflection:

Have you ever faced backlash for simply doing the right thing?



Main Course — The Call, the Crisis, and the Courage



Bite 1 – Mordecai’s Warning, Est 4:13–14

“Then Mordecai asked them to return this answer to Esther: ‘Don’t think to yourself that you will escape in the king’s house any more than all the Jews. For if you remain silent now, then relief and deliverance will come to the Jews from another place, but you and your father’s house will perish.

Who knows if you haven’t come to the kingdom for such a time as this?’”

Esther learns that her crown cannot shield her from Haman’s decree. Mordecai positions her heart: This is bigger than beauty. Bigger than privilege. This is purpose.

□ CST Reflection:

When have you realized that your position was actually an assignment?



Bite 2 – Fasting Before the Move, Est 4:15–16

“Go, gather together all the Jews who are present in Susa, and **fast for me**, and neither eat nor drink three days, night or day. I also and my maidens will fast in the same way. Then I will go in to the king, which is against the law; and if I perish, I perish.”

Esther requested a three-day fast — not a last resort, but a spiritual repositioning. Fasting clarifies. Fasting strengthens. Fasting shifts atmospheres. God was aligning Esther’s courage with divine timing.



Fasting Note: Always consult your pastor and doctor before engaging in fasting if you have health concerns.

□ CST Reflection:

What personal “fear barrier” do you need to fast through?



Bite 3 – The Turnaround, Esther 8:7

⁷Then King Ahasuerus said to Esther the queen and to Mordecai the Jew, “See, I have given Esther the house of Haman, and they have hanged him on the gallows because he laid his hand on the Jews. ⁸Write also to the Jews as it pleases you, in the king’s name, and seal it with the king’s ring; for the writing which is written in the king’s name, and sealed with the king’s ring, may not be reversed by any man.”

The same gallows Haman built for Mordecai became the tool of his own undoing.

When Esther stepped into purpose, God shifted everything:

- A decree reversed
- A nation rescued
- The enemy exposed
- Honor restored

□ **CST Reflection:**

Where in your life can God turn evil intentions into divine promotion?

 Dessert – God Works ALL Things Together, Rom 8:28

“We know that all things work together for good for those who love God, to those who are called according to his purpose.”

Esther didn’t come from royalty — she walked into it through obedience.

God used:

- her identity
- her humility
- her courage
- her fasting
- her placement

...to preserve an entire people. This is not a coincidence. This is covenant protection in action.

 To-Go Box — Take This with You

God positions before He promotes.

Purpose requires courage.

Fasting unlocks clarity.

And obedience activates destiny.

Write one short spiritual nugget you’re taking with you:

Prayer

“Lord, thank You for divine placement and divine purpose. Strengthen us like Esther to stand boldly, speak wisely, and obey quickly—even when fear rises. Teach us to fast, to listen, and to move when You call. And remind us that You are the God who turns every evil plot into a testimony of Your power. In Jesus’ name, amen.”

Write a short prayer about one thing you want to start praying about:

Review Questions

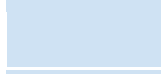
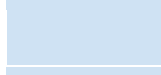
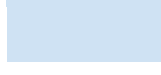
1. Who was King Ahasuerus’ first wife?

2. Why were the Jews’ lives threatened?

3. How long were they called to a fast?

4. What did Esther risk by going before the king unsummoned?

Activity – Mix & Match

Match	Name/Phrase	Description
	1 Haman	A Esther’s Cousin
	2 Mordecai	B Wanted to destroy Jews
	3 Vashti	C Death for coming without summons
	4 Why Fast was called	D Refused to come when summoned
	5 How Haman died	E By hanging at the Gallows

(Check the Appendix for answers)

Word Study

“King Ahasuerus” = Xerxes in some translations.

“Shushan” = Susa.

Practical counsel on fasting (consult pastor/doctor as applicable).



Notes & Group Discussion

BM1 — Lesson 2: Solomon

The Question That Unlocked a Legacy

 **Theme:** Prayer, the First Resort

 **Background Text:** 1 Kings 3:5–14; 2 Chron 1:7–12; 1 Kings 4:29–30

 **Key Verse:** 1 Kings 3:9 (WEB)

“Give your servant therefore an understanding heart to judge your people, that I may discern between good and evil; for who is able to judge this your great people?”

Appetizer — When God Says, “Ask Me for Anything”, 1 Kings 3:5–7

⁵ In Gibeon Yahweh appeared to Solomon in a dream by night; and God said, “Ask for what you want me to give you.” ⁶ Solomon said, “You have shown to your servant David my father great loving kindness, according as he walked before you in truth, righteousness, and uprightness of heart with you. You have kept for him this great loving kindness, that you have given him a son to sit on his throne, as it is today.

⁷ Now, Yahweh my God, you have made your servant king instead of David my father. I am just a little child. I don’t know how to go out or come in.

When God met Solomon in Gibeon, He didn’t start with a demand—He started with an invitation. Solomon could have asked for power, revenge, or riches. Instead, his first instinct was to talk with God about how to lead well. Before crowns and kingdoms, God tested the posture of his heart.

CST Reflection

Before greatness begins, God often tests the posture of the heart. When God hands us a “blank check” moment, what we ask for reveals what we truly value—comfort, control, or kingdom wisdom.

Reflection Question

When God gives you a blank check of opportunity, what would your prayer reveal about your heart’s priorities?



Main Course



Bite 1 — Humble Heart of a King, 1 Kings 3:9-10

⁹ Give your servant therefore an understanding heart to judge your people, that I may discern between good and evil; for who is able to judge this great people of yours? ¹⁰ This request pleased the Lord, that Solomon had asked this thing.

Solomon could have used prayer as a way to secure more comfort for himself. Instead, he asked for an understanding heart to serve God's people well. God was pleased, not because the words sounded spiritual, but because the request was selfless and aligned with His purposes.

□ CST

True prayer doesn't manipulate—it aligns. Solomon's request pleased God because it flowed from a heart that valued wisdom to serve over wealth to be seen.

Reflect:

How might your prayer life change if you sought God's heart before His hand?



Bite 2 — God's Response, 2 Chron 1:11–12

¹¹ God said to Solomon, "Because this was in your heart, and you have not asked riches, wealth, honor, or the life of those who hate you, nor yet have you asked for long life; but have asked for wisdom and knowledge for yourself, that you may judge my people, over whom I have made you king, ¹²therefore wisdom and knowledge is granted to you. I will give you riches, wealth, and honor, such as none of the kings have had who have been before you, and none after you will have."

God granted Solomon what he asked for—wisdom and understanding—and then added what he didn't ask for: riches, wealth, and honor. When wisdom comes first, blessings can follow without becoming idols. God can trust us with more when our heart is set on serving His people instead of promoting ourselves.

□ CST Reflection

God rewards those who seek understanding before abundance. When you desire wisdom more than you desire status, you make room for God to add what you never thought to ask for.

Reflect:

Where in your life do you feel pressure to chase “riches and honor” instead of asking first for wisdom to serve well?



Bite 3 — A Legacy That Starts in Prayer, 1 Kings 4:29–30

“God gave Solomon wisdom and understanding exceeding much, and very great understanding, even as the sand that is on the seashore. Solomon’s wisdom excelled the wisdom of all the children of the east, and all the wisdom of Egypt.”

Solomon’s wisdom became his reputation. People knew him not just for what he had, but for the way he thought, judged, and led. What began as a private conversation with God in a dream turned into a public legacy that reached the nations. Solomon’s story shows that legacy doesn’t begin on a platform—it begins in God’s presence.

Reflect

How could your private time with God today shape how people remember your life tomorrow?



Dessert — The Legacy of a Wise Heart

God gave Solomon abundant wisdom and understanding “like the sand that is on the seashore,” and his wisdom exceeded that of all the surrounding nations.

The story of Solomon reminds us that real greatness starts with a listening heart. When we ask for wisdom instead of applause, God can use our lives to bless people we may never meet.

□ CST Reflection

Finish this quietly: “Lord, help me want _____ more than _____.”

To-Go Box

- The strength of your leadership flows from the sincerity of your prayers.
- God is pleased when you ask for wisdom to serve others well.
- Solomon’s legacy began not with a throne, but with a conversation with God.

Carry this truth into your week:

Ask God for wisdom first—then trust Him with everything else.

Prayer

“Lord, thank You for the example of Solomon’s request. Teach me to value wisdom over wealth and understanding over image. Align my heart with Your priorities so that my prayers please You. Give me an understanding heart to serve well wherever You have placed me. Let my life reflect Your wisdom and bring You honor. In Jesus’ name, amen.”

Activity – “Wisdom First” (Fill-in-the-Blank)

Complete the statements based on today’s lesson:

1. Solomon asked God for _____ and _____ to govern His people.
2. God was pleased because Solomon did *not* ask for _____, _____, or the _____ of his enemies.
3. Solomon’s legacy teaches us that _____ comes before _____.

(Check the Appendix for answers)

Note Section— Group Discussion & Personal Study

Use this space to jot down insights, testimonies, or key points from group discussion:

BM1 — Lesson 3: Jesus

Prayer the First Resort

 **Theme:** Prayer, the First Resort

 **Background Text:** Luke 5:15–16; Luke 11:1–4; Luke 18:1–8; John 17

 **Key Verse:** Luke 18:1 (WEB)

“He also spoke a parable to them that they must always pray, and not give up;”

Appetizer — WWJD: What Would Jesus Do? Luke 5:15–16

¹⁵ But the report concerning him spread much more, and great multitudes came together to hear, and to be healed by him of their infirmities. ¹⁶ But he withdrew himself into the desert, and prayed.”

Crowds kept coming. Needs kept growing. Pressure kept rising. And Jesus did something that still challenges us: **He withdrew to pray.** He didn’t wait until everything broke. He didn’t treat prayer like a backup plan. If we’re asking *WWJD*—here’s a clear answer: **He would pray first, especially when life got louder.**

Reflection Question

When your life gets busier or more stressful, what usually gets cut first—rest, fun, prayer, or something else?

Main Course – The Mediator and the Model

Bite 1 — “Lord, Teach Us to Pray”, Luke 11:1–4

¹ When he finished praying in a certain place, one of his disciples said to him, “Lord, teach us to pray, just as John also taught his disciples.”

² He said to them, “When you pray, say,
‘Our Father in heaven, may your name be kept holy.
May your Kingdom come.
May your will be done on earth, as it is in heaven.

³ Give us day by day our daily bread.

⁴ Forgive us our sins, for we ourselves also forgive everyone who is indebted to us.
Bring us not into temptation, but deliver us from the evil one.’

The disciples didn't ask Jesus to teach them crowds, platforms, or popularity—they asked about prayer. They watched His life and realized **prayer was the engine**. Jesus gave them a pattern: start with God's holiness and Kingdom, trust Him for daily needs, walk in forgiveness, and ask for strength in temptation.

Reflection Question

Which part of that pattern do you rely on most—worship, daily needs, forgiveness, or spiritual strength? Which part do you skip?

Bite 2 — Don't Quit Praying, Luke 18:1–5

¹ He also spoke a parable to them that they must always pray, and not give up, ² saying, “There was a judge in a certain city who didn't fear God, and didn't respect man. ³ A widow was in that city, and she often came to him, saying, ‘Defend me from my adversary!’

⁴ He wouldn't for a while; but afterward he said to himself, ‘Though I neither fear God, nor respect man, ⁵ yet because this widow bothers me, I will defend her, or else she will wear me out by her continual coming.’

Jesus tells a story about persistence because He knows how the mind and heart works. Delay can make you tired. Silence can make you doubt. But Jesus is clear: **don't give up**.

Reflection Question

Is there something you used to pray about that you stopped praying for because it took too long?

Bite 3 — God Is Not Like the Unjust Judge, Luke 18:6–8

⁶ The Lord said, “Listen to what the unrighteous judge says. ⁷ Won't God avenge his chosen ones, who are crying out to him day and night, and yet he exercises patience with them? ⁸ I tell you that he will avenge them quickly. Nevertheless, when the Son of Man comes, will he find faith on the earth?”

CST Thought

God keeps His promises—always. Even in seasons of delay or confusion, His Word sustains us.

Jeremiah 29 reminds us to seek God, pray for the welfare of the place we're in, and trust His larger plan for our lives.

Author's Testimony – A Lesson in Trust

One morning, I began my day with prayer:

“Lord, please be in charge of today. Allow me to rely on Your peace. Take control of today.”

Before 8 a.m., everything seemed to go sideways. A tenant's water was shut off, and there were other moving pieces that could have easily sent me into stress mode. But instead of panicking, I felt an unexpected peace.

God quietly reminded me, “Just call the local store.”

I did. They gave me the name of a retired plumber. He came out, fixed the issue, and the cost was exactly the \$40 I had withdrawn the night before—without knowing why I would need it. That's God's foresight and favor.

Reflection Questions

1. What situation did you trust Jesus to handle, and what was the result?

Dessert — Prayer that Unites, John 17:20–21

“Not for these only do I pray, but for those also who believe in me through their word, that they may all be one, even as you, Father, are in me, and I in you, that they also may be one in us; that the world may believe that you sent me.”

Even before the cross, Jesus prayed for us. He sought the Father for strength, direction, and surrender. That's the model: **prayer in the beginning, prayer in the middle, prayer at the finish.**

To-Go Box

- This life is not over until your last breath.
- Keep praying. Keep trusting. Keep resting in the One who intercedes for you.
- “Pray without ceasing.” (1 Thessalonians 5:17, WEB)

Carry this truth into every season: Jesus still meets you first in prayer.

 Group Prayer – Following Jesus’ Example

Remember Jesus’ prayer in Gethsemane and His High Priestly prayer in John 17. Pray for unity, peace, and strength.

“Lord, help us to surrender our will to Yours. Teach us to rest in Your promises, and fill us with the same glory and unity You shared with the Father. Make us one in heart and purpose.

In Jesus’ name, amen.”

 Notes Section— Group Discussion & Personal Study

BM1 — Lesson 4 Paul & Silas

Faith in the Dark

 **Theme:** Prayer, The First Resort/Praise in Midnight Moments

 **Background Text:** Acts 16:16–34; Isaiah 26:3; Phil 4:6–7

 **Key Verse:** Acts 16:25–26 (WEB)

But about midnight Paul and Silas were praying and singing hymns to God, and the prisoners were listening to them. Suddenly there was a great earthquake, so that the foundations of the prison were shaken; and immediately all the doors were opened, and everyone's bonds were loosened."

Appetizer – The Mindset is Everything, Isa 26:3

You will keep whoever's mind is steadfast in perfect peace, because he trusts in you.

Although no one was promised the “Easy St” while spreading the Word of God, your trust that you have in him, no matter the situation is the setup for victory. God promises perfect peace to those who fix their minds on Him. His peace is not the absence of trouble, but a deep, enduring confidence in His unchanging nature.

Reflection Question

When has God given you peace when everything around you said panic?

Main Course – Power in the Praises

Bite 1 – The Test in Their Testament, Acts 16:22–24, 31

²²The multitude rose up together against them, and the magistrates tore their clothes off of them, and commanded them to be beaten with rods. ²³When they had laid many stripes on them, they threw them into prison, charging the jailer to keep them safely, ²⁴who, having received such a charge, threw them into the inner prison, and secured their feet in the stocks."

Paul and Silas helped set a slave girl free from a spirit that was controlling her.
Instead of getting a “thank you,” they were:

- Stripped
- Beaten
- Thrown into the **inner prison**
- Locked in stocks

Oftentimes we don't hear an immediate 'thank you' for doing what is right. Our response shouldn't be based on what they do in return, but when he has called us to do – period. That's the test, our follow-through produces the testimony.

Bite 2 – The Jailhouse Rocked, Acts 16:25–26

²⁵ But about midnight Paul and Silas were praying and singing hymns to God, and the prisoners were listening to them. ²⁶ Suddenly there was a great earthquake, so that the foundations of the prison were shaken; and immediately all the doors were opened, and everyone's bonds were loosened."

God answers in a wild way:

- Earthquake
- Open doors
- Loose chains

It's amazing what can happen when you keep your mind stayed on Him (see Isaiah 26:3). Their voices turned a prison into a sanctuary, and their pain became a praise report. Sometimes your midnight melody becomes someone else's breakthrough song. **That's what made the jailhouse rock!** Certain songs, like "Holy Forever" by CeCe Winans, strengthen my heart when life feels heavy because they lift my focus off the problem and onto His power.

Reflection Question

What worship song or prayer brings you back to peace when life feels heavy?

Bite 3 – Contagious Praise, Collective Breakthrough, Acts 16:27–30

²⁷ The jailer, being roused out of sleep and seeing the prison doors open, drew his sword and was about to kill himself, supposing that the prisoners had escaped. ²⁸ But Paul cried with a loud voice, saying, 'Don't

harm yourself, for we are all here!’ ²⁹ He called for lights and sprang in, and, fell down trembling before Paul and Silas, ³⁰ and brought them out and said, ‘Sirs, what must I do to be saved?’

CST Thought

“Do thyself no harm”

The guard fell asleep on duty, and it could have cost him his life! He didn’t want to face his boss and try to explain why the prison was empty (with dried drool on his face)! Paul and Silas’s praise didn’t just free them—it freed everyone in earshot.

The first miracle Paul and Silas walk in is **self-control**. They stayed, not because they’re stuck, but because they see the jailer’s life is on the line. Their pain became the door to someone else’s **salvation**.



Word Study

Yadah (Hebrew) –means praise



Reflection Question

Who has been influenced by your praise or perseverance?



Dessert – Joy Unspeakable Joy, Acts 16:31–34

³¹ They said, ‘Believe in the Lord Jesus Christ, and you will be saved, you and your household.’ ³² They spoke the word of the Lord to him, and to all who were in his house.

³³ He took them the same hour of the night, and washed their stripes, and was immediately baptized, he and all his household. ³⁴ He brought them up into his house, and set food before them, and rejoiced greatly, with all his household, having believed in God.”

CST Commentary

Praise is contagious, and faith is transferable. Paul and Silas’s obedience led to the warden’s family’s salvation. The first miracle Paul and Silas walk in is **self-control**. They stayed, not because they’re stuck, but because they see the jailer’s life is on the line. Their pain became the door to someone else’s **salvation**.

What began as a night of pain ended in joy—unspeakable joy.

To-Go Box

- When you choose praise over panic, God moves immediately.
- He can still shake foundations, open doors, and loose chains—not just yours, but everyone within reach of your faith.
- No matter what the problem, Jesus will always be the answer.

Carry this truth into every season:

Your midnight praise can become somebody else's morning miracle.

Prayer

“Lord Jesus, Thank You for being with us in our midnight moments. Teach us to choose praise over panic and to trust that You are working even when we cannot see it. Let our worship create an atmosphere where others can experience freedom, salvation, and joy. Use our pain as a platform for Your power. In Your name we pray, amen.”

Reflection & Group Discussion

1. When has God used a hard season in your life to encourage someone else?

2. What is one “midnight situation” you need to surrender to God in praise right now?

3. Who comes to mind when you think about someone who needs to “hear” your praise?

 Group Reflection

Sometimes when the Spirit prompts you to shout or praise, it's not just for you.
Someone within earshot might need that breakthrough.
Glory be to God for every chain that falls when we praise.

 Notes Page — Group Discussion & Personal Study

Appendix – Breakfast Month 1 Answer Key

Theme: Prayer, the First Resort

Lesson 1 – Esther: Second Is the Best



Activity – Mix & Match

Match each name/phrase with the correct description:

Match		Name/Phrase		Description
B	1	Haman	A	Esther's Uncle
A	2	Mordecai	B	Wanted to destroy Jews
D	3	Vashti	C	Death for coming without summons
C	4	Why Fast was called	D	Refused to come when summoned
E	5	How Haman died	E	By hanging at the Gallows

Answer Key:

- 1 → b (Haman – plotter who wanted to destroy the Jews)
- 2 → a (Mordecai – cousin who refused to bow)
- 3 → d (Vashti – former queen removed)
- 4 → c (The Fast – three days before Esther went to the king)
- 5 → e (The Gallows – where Haman was executed)

Lesson 2 – Solomon: The Question That Unlocked a Legacy

Activity – Fill in the Blank

1. Solomon asked God for _____ and _____ to govern His people.
2. God was pleased because Solomon did not ask for _____, _____, or the _____ of his enemies.
3. Solomon’s story shows that _____ comes before _____.

Answer Key:

1. wisdom and understanding
2. long life, riches/wealth, or the death/lives of his enemies
3. wisdom comes before wealth

Lesson 3 – Jesus: Prayer the First Resort

Activity – “Prayer Map” (Gethsemane-style prayer)

This activity is reflective, not right-or-wrong:

- Students write a two-part prayer:
 - “Father, I feel...” (honesty)
 - “Nevertheless, Your will be done in...” (surrender)

Answer Key:

- Open-ended/journaling. No fixed correct answers.

Lesson 4 – Paul & Silas: Faith in the Dark



Activity – “Midnight Playlist” (or your final title)

Students:

1. Write one worship song or phrase that helps them focus on God.
2. Complete: “When I feel _____, this reminds me that God is _____.”

Answer Key:

- Open-ended/journaling. No fixed correct answers.

SOUL FOOD BIBLE STUDY SERIES

Break • fast - Month 2

Adult Edition



Theme:

The Art of Through

The Lord is my shepherd; I shall not want...

Psalms 23:1 (KJV)

Table of Contents

SOUL FOOD BIBLE STUDY SERIES	1
The Art of Through.....	1
Introduction – The Art of Through.....	4
 Breakfast Edition Month 2: Lesson 1 – Joseph.....	5
The Young Dreamer	5
 Appetizer – The Dream That Started It All, Gen 37:5–8	5
 Main Course	6
 Bite 1 — Betrayed but Chosen, Gen 37:18–19, 22a, 28	6
 Bite 2 — Integrity in the Dark, Gen 39:7–8,17, 20	6
 Bite 3 — From Prison to Palace, Gen 41:15-16, 37-39.....	7
 Dessert — Faith Rewarded, Gen 42:5–6.....	7
 Activity – Fill in the Blank	8
 BM2 — Lesson 2: Hannah.....	10
Barren but Not Lifeless	10
 Appetizer – The Weight of Waiting, 1 Sam 1:7–8	10
 Main Course	11
 Bite 1 – Provoked but Persistent, 1 Sam 1:9–11	11
 Bite 2 – Misunderstood but Heard, 1 Sam 1:12–15.....	11
 Bite 3 – Promise Given, Promise Kept, 1 Sam 1:16–18, 20	12
 Dessert – The Song of Victory, 1 Sam 2:1–2	12
 Activity – Word Scramble: Hannah’s Hope.....	13
 BM2: Lesson 3 – Abram	15
No Heir, Wait Here.....	15
 Appetizer – Faith Between Promises Gen 15:1–3.....	15
 Bite 1 – Count the Stars, Gen 15:4–6	15
 Bite 2 – When We Try to “Help” God, Gen 16:1–4.....	16
 Bite 3 – Name Changed, Same Promise, Gen 17:1–5, 7	16
 Dessert – Faith Rewarded Through Time, Rom 4:20–21	17
 Activity – True or False: Trust the Timeline	18
 BM2 — Lesson 4: Chronic Conditions.....	19
 Victory Through the Blood	19
 Author’s Foreword.....	19

 Appetizer – Twelve Years of Pain, Luke 8:42b–43a.....	19
 Main Course – Faith That Reaches Out.....	20
 Bite 1 – A Desperate Touch, Luke 8:43b–44	20
 Bite 2 – “Who Touched Me?” Luke 8:45–47	21
 Bite 3 – New Name, New Peace, Luke 8:48.....	21
 Author’s Commentary	21
 Dessert – Push Through the Crowd	22
 Activity – Word Search Puzzle	24
 Appendix – Breakfast Month 2 (AE) Answer Key.....	25
 Lesson 1 – Joseph: The Young Dreamer	25
 Lesson 2 – Hannah: Barren but Not Lifeless.....	25
 Lesson 3 – Abram: No Heir, Wait Here	27
 Lesson 4 – Victory Through the Blood	28

Introduction – The Art of Through

“The LORD is my shepherd; I shall not want.” — Psalm 23:1 (KJV)

Many times in life, we feel stuck. It might be at the starting line, or right in the messy middle. At times, it feels like our feet are chained to invisible blocks buried deep in the ground. No matter how much we want to move forward, something holds us in place.



This month’s lessons are designed to walk us through stories of people who faced real adversity—but didn’t give up. From Joseph in the pit, to Hannah in her barrenness, to Abram caught between promise and fulfillment, to those who pushed through crowds and pain for a touch from Jesus—each one shows us the **art of through**.

You don’t need to be a pro, a priest, or a “seasoned saint” to make it through hard seasons. You just need determination, honest faith, and a willingness to keep walking with God when giving up would be easier.

Everyone has a story. Many stories are similar, but your journey still feels uniquely your own. Psalm 23, written by David, reflects the heart of someone who knew rejection, doubt, and danger—yet kept following the Shepherd. Victory didn’t come by going *around* the valley, but by walking *through* it with God.

This segment of study explores biblical figures who endured trials and still pressed through. Their stories remind us that in God, we win not by skipping the struggle, but by trusting the Shepherd to lead us through to the other side.



SOUL FOOD BIBLE STUDY (AE)



Breakfast Edition Month 2: Lesson 1 – Joseph

The Young Dreamer



Theme: The Art of Through



Background Text: Genesis 37; 39; 41–42



Key Verse: Genesis 42:6 (WEB)

“Joseph’s brothers came, and bowed themselves down to him with their faces to the earth.”



Appetizer – The Dream That Started It All, Gen 37:5–8

⁵Joseph dreamed a dream, and he told it to his brothers, and they hated him all the more. ⁶He said to them, ‘Please hear this dream which I have dreamed: ⁷for behold, we were binding sheaves in the field, and behold, my sheaf arose and also stood upright; and behold, your sheaves came around, and bowed down to my sheaf.’

⁸His brothers said to him, ‘Will you indeed reign over us? Or will you indeed have dominion over us?’ They hated him all the more for his dreams and for his words.”

Joseph saw a glimpse of his future long before anyone else believed it. What God showed him made his brothers jealous and angry, but their feeling didn’t invalidate the fact that dream still came from God.

□ CST – Called Before You’re Ready

God can give us glimpses of our destiny before others are ready to believe it—or before *we* fully understand it. Favor can feel lonely when the people closest to you don’t see what God has spoken over your life.

Reflection:

How do you stay humble when God’s favor on your life creates tension with others?

Main Course

Bite 1 — Betrayed but Chosen, Gen 37:18–19, 22a, 28

¹⁸They saw him afar off, and before he came near to them, they conspired against him to kill him. ¹⁹They said to one another, “Behold, this dreamer comes. ²²Reuben said to them, “Shed no blood. Throw him into this pit that is in the wilderness, but lay no hand on him”

²⁸Midianites who were merchants passed by, and they drew and lifted up Joseph out of the pit, and sold Joseph to the Ishmaelites for twenty pieces of silver. They brought Joseph into Egypt.

The very people who should have protected Joseph became the ones who betrayed him—but their evil could not cancel God’s plan.

CST – When Betrayal Becomes a Bridge

Sometimes betrayal doesn’t block your destiny—it *pushes* you toward it. The pit felt like punishment, but it was really a passageway. What others meant for harm, God was already folding into His larger story of rescue and preservation.

Reflection:

Think of a time when someone’s betrayal or rejection pushed you into a new chapter. How might God have been redirecting you?

Bite 2 — Integrity in the Dark, Gen 39:7–8,17, 20

⁷After these things, his master’s wife set her eyes on Joseph; and she said, ‘Lie with me.’ ⁸But he refused, and said... ‘How then can I do this great wickedness, and sin against God?’ ¹⁷She spoke to him according to these words, saying, “The Hebrew servant, whom you have brought to us, came in to me to mock me, ²⁰Joseph’s master took him, and put him into the prison, the place where the king’s prisoners were bound, and he was there in custody.

Joseph guarded his character even when no one from home was watching and when compromise might have seemed to make his life easier. His integrity and personal conviction mattered more in the moment than the temptation to be agreeable..

CST – Holiness When No One’s Looking

Holiness means running away from what others explain away. Joseph understood that sin isn’t just breaking rules—it’s breaking God’s heart. He chose obedience over opportunity, even though it cost him his reputation and his freedom.

Reflection:

What guardrails (boundaries, habits, or people) help protect your integrity when temptation keeps coming “day after day”?

Bite 3 — From Prison to Palace, Gen 41:15-16, 37-39

¹⁵ Pharaoh said to Joseph, “I have dreamed a dream, and there is no one who can interpret it. I have heard it said of you, that when you hear a dream you can interpret it.”¹⁶ Joseph answered Pharaoh, saying, ‘It isn’t in me. God will give Pharaoh an answer of peace.’

³⁷ The thing was good in the eyes of Pharaoh, and in the eyes of all his servants. ³⁸ Pharaoh said to his servants, “Can we find such a one as this, a man in whom is the Spirit of God?” ³⁹ Pharaoh said to Joseph, “Because God has shown you all of this, there is no one so discreet and wise as you.

In one day, Joseph went from prisoner to prime minister—but he made sure the glory went to God, not himself. God was preparing Joseph in places people forgot about: the pit and the prison. Those “wasted years” became his training ground in leadership, humility, and dependence on God. When the door finally opened, Joseph was ready—not because he was perfect, but because he stayed faithful.

Reflection:

Where do you feel “hidden” or overlooked right now? How might God be quietly preparing you for your next assignment?

Dessert — Faith Rewarded, Gen 42:5-6

⁵ The sons of Israel came to buy among those who came, for the famine was in the land of Canaan. ⁶ Joseph was the governor over the land. It was he who sold to all the people of the land. Joseph’s brothers came, and bowed themselves down to him with their faces to the earth.

The vision came to pass. His brothers did in fact bow before him, as he served in a position of authority just below Pharaoh. Even though they thought it would be a bad thing, Jehovah Jireh – the God who supplies, used their younger brother to prevent their starvation and preserve their survival! Their rejection of him propelled him into the position of savior for a region.

To-Go Box

- The **pit**, the **prison**, and the **palace** were all part of Joseph’s training, not random pain.
- Betrayal couldn’t block God’s plan; it became the bridge God used to move Joseph into position.
- Integrity in hidden places prepared Joseph to carry influence in public places.
- God’s promotion often comes suddenly, but the preparation is usually slow and silent.
- What God speaks in a dream, He will fulfill in His time—our job is to stay faithful “through,” not just shout about the promise at the start.

Closing Prayer

“Lord God, thank You for the story of Joseph and for reminding us that You are working even when life feels unfair. Help us to trust You in the pit, to walk in integrity when no one is watching, and to stay faithful in seasons where we feel forgotten. Strengthen our faith to believe that Your promises will come to pass in Your perfect timing. In Jesus’ name, amen.”

Reflection Questions

1. Where do you see yourself in Joseph’s journey right now—pit, prison, palace, or somewhere in between?

2. Write down one promise, dream, or calling from God that you refuse to give up on, even if it seems delayed.

Activity – Fill in the Blank

1. Joseph’s brothers sold him for _____ pieces of silver.
2. Joseph resisted the temptation of _____.
3. Pharaoh said Joseph was filled with the _____ of God.
4. Joseph’s brothers bowed before him in _____.

(Check the Appendix for answers)

 Notes Page — Group Discussion & Personal Study

BM2 — Lesson 2: Hannah

Barren but Not Lifeless

 **Theme:** Prayer in the Pain

 **Background Text:** 1 Samuel 1–2

 **Key Verse:** 1 Samuel 1:27 (WEB)

“I prayed for this child, and Yahweh has given me my petition which I asked of him.”

Introduction

Elkanah was a Jewish man with two wives. In that culture, although love was part of why you married, having children was a major factor. Many times, barren women ended up divorced or pushed to the margins of society. Peninnah and Hannah were his wives, but Hannah could not have children.

Have you ever felt like you were “stuck” in someone else’s shadow? Like no matter what you did, the other person always seemed to be one step ahead? That was Hannah’s situation. Year after year, she was humiliated and reminded how much of a “failure” she was as a wife because she could not give Elkanah an heir.

At least her husband loved her, right? It didn’t feel that way. The voice of her tormentor cut deeply, and it seemed as if her prayers were bouncing off the ceiling.

Appetizer – The Weight of Waiting, 1 Sam 1:7–8

“So year by year, when she went up to Yahweh’s house, her rival provoked her; therefore she wept, and didn’t eat. Elkanah her husband said to her, ‘Hannah, why do you weep? Why don’t you eat? Why is your heart grieved? Am I not better to you than ten sons?’”

In Jewish culture, having children is everything. If a man did not have a child, even if he was a scholar, he was not given the same honor. Their cultural and ethnic code weighed heavily on Hannah’s mind. Her husband had every right, culturally, to divorce her and marry someone else. Inheritance and family legacy were tied to children.

In today’s terms, Hannah showed signs of deep depression and grief. She felt that no one around her really understood or could comfort her. She stopped eating, cried endlessly, and felt useless.

If you or someone you know is going through something similar, there is help available. You do not have to battle alone—reach out to your church family, a community counselor, or a trusted friend.

□ **CST: Desperation can drive determination.**

How does persistent prayer reshape hopelessness into hope?

Main Course

Bite 1 – Provoked but Persistent, 1 Sam 1:9–11

⁹ So Hannah rose up after they had finished eating and drinking in Shiloh. Now Eli the priest was sitting on his seat by the doorpost of Yahweh’s temple. ¹⁰ She was in bitterness of soul, and prayed to Yahweh, weeping bitterly. ¹¹ She vowed a vow, and said, “Yahweh of Armies, if you will indeed look at the affliction of your servant and remember me, and not forget your servant, but will give to your servant a boy, then I will give him to Yahweh all the days of his life, and no razor shall come on his head.”

What do you do when you are really going through it? Who is the best person to turn to who can *truly* help? Many times, we go first to people who can listen—but cannot change anything. Hannah’s womb was “lifeless,” but she took her lifelessness to the Living God.

□ **CST: Pulse Check**

Take a moment to write a prayer request—personal or for your family—that you want the Lord to work out.

Bite 2 – Misunderstood but Heard, 1 Sam 1:12–15

As she continued praying before Yahweh, Eli observed her mouth. Now Hannah spoke in her heart; only her lips moved, but her voice was not heard. Therefore Eli thought she was drunk. Eli said to her, ‘How long will you be drunk? Get rid of your wine!’ Hannah answered, ‘No, my lord, I am a woman of a sorrowful spirit. I have drunk neither wine nor strong drink, but I poured out my soul before Yahweh.’

When you are at your lowest, even “religious” people might misjudge your struggle. But Hannah didn’t let a man’s mistake stop her from talking to her Maker. God hears the prayers that are too deep for words. God is our Promise

Keeper, but sometimes *we* make promises to Him and then break them. If that has ever happened in your life, be honest with God.

Reflections:

Why is it important that we take these acts seriously? Can you think of examples of when people give or make vows (marriage, baptism, oaths, commitments)?

Bite 3 – Promise Given, Promise Kept, 1 Sam 1:16–18, 20

¹⁶“Don’t consider your servant a wicked woman; for I have been speaking out of the abundance of my complaint and my provocation.” ¹⁷Then Eli answered, “Go in peace; and may the God^[a] of Israel grant your petition that you have asked of him.” ¹⁸She said, “Let your servant find favor in your sight.” So the woman went her way and ate; and her facial expression wasn’t sad any more.

²⁰When the time had come, Hannah conceived, and bore a son; and she named him Samuel,^[a] saying, “Because I have asked him of Yahweh.”

It is OK to correct a false narrative. Allow your virtue and truth to shine even in dark situations. Peace showed up before the answer did. Hannah left her burden at the altar. She didn’t have the baby yet, but she had the “yes” in her spirit. Sometimes God changes your heart before He changes your situation to prove He is your source of joy.

She conceived and gave birth to Samuel, and later brought him back to serve the Lord, just as she had vowed (1 Samuel 1:19–28).

CST: Answered prayer often requires releasing what we prayed for.

Can you trust God enough to give back the blessing He gave you—time, talent, or even a person?

Dessert – The Song of Victory, 1 Sam 2:1–2

“Hannah prayed, and said, ‘My heart exults in Yahweh! My horn is exalted in Yahweh. My mouth is enlarged over my enemies, because I rejoice in your salvation. There is no one as holy as Yahweh, for there is no one besides you, nor is there any rock like our God.’

True praise flows from answered pain. Hannah’s song came from a place of long weeping and finally, breakthrough.

Reflection:

What song has your victory written for you? (It could be an actual song, a testimony, or a phrase you hold onto.)

To-Go Box

Hannah's story proves that barrenness—physical, emotional, or spiritual—is never the final word.

- Faith speaks life into empty places.
 - Honest prayer is better than fake peace.
 - God can give you peace in your heart before the answer shows up in your hands.
-

Closing Prayer

“Lord, thank You for Hannah’s story and for reminding us that You hear the cries we pray in secret.

Teach us to pour out our hearts honestly before You, to honor the vows we make, and to trust You with both our pain and our promises.

Where we feel barren or empty, speak life.

Where we have been misunderstood, let Your understanding surround us.

And when You answer, help us to give the glory—and even the blessing—back to You.

In Jesus’ name, amen.”

Activity – Word Scramble: Hannah’s Hope

Unscramble each word to reveal key truths from the lesson. (*Hints in parentheses*)

1. **NNAHHA** (her name) _____.
 2. **ULSAME** (the son she bore) _____.
 3. **EYARDP** (what she did earnestly) _____.
 4. **THFAI** (what God rewarded) _____.
 5. **LIHEFSI** (2 words, what she gave back to God) _____.
-

Multiple Choice /Fill in the Blank

1. Elkanah was married to _____.

- a. Hannah and Peninnah
- b. Hannah and Phinehas
- c. Hophni and Peninnah
- d. None of the above

Answer.

2. Elkanah and his wives would go to sacrifice in _____ at the Lord of _____.

- a. Judah, Heaven's Armies
- b. Judah, Heaven's Angries
- c. Shiloh, Heaven's Armies
- d. Shiloh, Heaven's Angries

Answer.

3. A vow is a .

4. Hannah promised to never _____.

- (a) Fight Peninnah
- (b) Cut her child's hair
- (c) Lie again
- (d) Come to the temple drunk

Answer.

5. "Seeing her lips _____ but hearing no _____, he thought she had been _____."

Notes Page — Group Discussion & Personal Study

BM2: Lesson 3 – Abram

No Heir, Wait Here

 **Theme:** Trusting God when the wait is long

 **Background Text:** Genesis 15:1–6; 16:1–5; 17:1–8

 **Key Verse:** Genesis 15:6 (WEB)

“He believed in Yahweh, who credited it to him for righteousness.”

Appetizer – Faith Between Promises Gen 15:1–3

¹ After these things Yahweh’s word came to Abram in a vision, saying, ‘Don’t be afraid, Abram. I am your shield, your exceedingly great reward.’ ² Abram said, ‘Lord Yahweh, what will you give me, since I go childless, and he who will inherit my estate is Eliezer of Damascus?’

³ Abram said, ‘Behold, to me you have given no children; and, behold, one born in my house is my heir.’

Many of us know what it feels like to sit between what God said and what we see. Abram had promises, but no child. Blessing was on his life, but barrenness was in his house. Abram didn’t pretend everything was fine—he told God honestly where his heart was: “What good are all these blessings if I don’t have the one thing You promised?”

Main Course

Bite 1 – Count the Stars, Gen 15:4–6

Behold, Yahweh’s word came to him, saying, ‘This man will not be your heir, but he who will come out of your own body will be your heir.’ Yahweh brought him outside, and said, ‘Look now toward the sky, and count the stars, if you are able to count them.’ He said to Abram, ‘So shall your offspring be.’ He believed in Yahweh; and he reckoned it to him for righteousness.

God did not deny Abram’s disappointment; He answered it with a bigger picture. God pulled Abram outside, pointed to the stars, and told him to count the uncountable.

□ **CST: Faith is often proven in the unseen.**

When sight fades, trust sharpens. God asked Abram to believe a promise that his eyes could not yet verify, and heaven called that belief “righteousness.”

Reflection:

What “stars” is God asking you to look at and believe for—even when your current situation says the opposite?

Bite 2 – When We Try to “Help” God, Gen 16:1–4

¹ Now Sarai, Abram’s wife, bore him no children. She had a servant, an Egyptian, whose name was Hagar.

² Sarai said to Abram, ‘See now, Yahweh has restrained me from bearing. Please go in to my servant. It may be that I will obtain children by her.’ Abram listened to the voice of Sarai.

³ After Abram had lived ten years in the land of Canaan, Sarai took Hagar the Egyptian, her servant, and gave her to Abram her husband to be his wife. ⁴ He went to Hagar, and she conceived. When she saw that she had conceived, her mistress was despised in her eyes.

Sarai and Abram reached a breaking point in the waiting and decided to “help” God. Their plan produced a child—but also tension, comparison, and conflict. Waiting is not always easy but oftentimes required.

When we rush what God promised to perfect, we create situations He never asked us to manage. Grace can redeem our detours, but consequences are still real.

Reflection:

Where are you most tempted to “fix it yourself” instead of waiting on God’s way and God’s time?

Bite 3 – Name Changed, Same Promise, Gen 17:1–5, 7

¹ When Abram was ninety-nine years old, Yahweh appeared to Abram and said to him, ‘I am God Almighty. Walk before me, and be blameless. ² I will make my covenant between me and you, and will multiply you exceedingly.’ ³ Abram fell on his face. God talked with him, saying, ⁴ ‘As for me, behold, my covenant is with you. You will be the father of a multitude of nations.

⁵ Your name will no longer be called Abram, but your name will be Abraham; for I have made you the father of a multitude of nations. ⁷ I will establish my covenant between me and you and your offspring after you throughout their generations for an everlasting covenant...’

God revisited Abram years later—not to cancel the promise, but to **expand** it and attach it to a covenant. He also changed Abram’s name to Abraham to match what heaven already saw.

He renames us to remind us of who we are becoming, not what we’ve been. Abraham had to learn to answer to a name that sounded like the promise *before* the promise fully showed up.

Reflection:

Is there an area where God is calling you to think, speak, or walk according to His promise—before you see it?



Dessert – Faith Rewarded Through Time, Rom 4:20–21

²⁰ Yet, looking to the promise of God, he didn’t waver through unbelief, but grew strong through faith, giving glory to God, ²¹ and being fully assured that what he had promised, he was also able to perform.

Abraham’s story says:

1. Real faith is honest enough to ask hard questions.
2. Real faith can still stumble, but God picks it back up.
3. God’s timing is perfect, even when it feels “late.”

Reflection:

God doesn’t forget; He fulfills. Abraham’s faith grew stronger over time, even while the promise seemed delayed.

How can you glorify God while you’re still waiting for your “Isaac” to come forth?



To-Go Box

- Faith is not just belief—it’s **endurance** through delay.
- Questioning God honestly doesn’t disqualify you; staying stuck in unbelief does.
- Human shortcuts (like Hagar) may seem faster, but they complicate what God intended to be clean.
- When God reaffirms His promise, He often calls you by a new name or identity that lines up with your future.
- God’s timeline is not denial; it’s divine alignment.

Word Study

- **Abram** – “Exalted Father”
- **Abraham** – “Father of Many Nations”
- **El Shaddai** – “God Almighty,” the all-sufficient One who sustains, provides, and fulfills His promises.

Closing Prayer

“God Almighty, El Shaddai, thank you for being faithful even when my faith feels small. Teach me to wait on Your timing instead of forcing my own solutions. Help me to believe Your promises when I can’t yet see the evidence.

Rename the places in my life that still sound like doubt and align my identity with what You have spoken. Make me fully assured that what You have promised, You are also able to perform. In Jesus’ name, amen.”

Activity – True or False: Trust the Timeline

1. Abram’s faith never wavered from the start.
☐ True ☐ False
2. Sarai suggested a human solution to a divine promise.
☐ True ☐ False
3. God changed Abram’s name after he demonstrated obedience.
☐ True ☐ False
4. Hagar’s son was the covenant child.
☐ True ☐ False
5. God’s timing tests faith before fulfilling it.
☐ True ☐ False

(Check the Appendix for answers)

† BM2 — Lesson 4: Chronic Conditions

💧 Victory Through the Blood

📘 **Theme:** Faith That Heals

📖 **Background Text:** Luke 8:42b–48

🔑 **Key Verse:** Luke 8:48 (WEB)

He said to her, ‘**Daughter, cheer up. Your faith has made you well. Go in peace.**’

✨ Author’s Foreword (Intro/Reflection Setup)



“Unclean, Unclean, Unclean!”

In the Jewish law, as depicted in the Pentateuch, many illnesses and conditions could make a person “unclean.” Those labeled unclean could not enter the temple, attend gatherings, or move freely in the community. Some were restricted to their homes or pushed outside normal society. They had to *announce* their condition whenever they came near people.

Imagine living in a world where you had to brandish your “dirty secret” like the old Scarlet Letter—exposed, ashamed, and isolated.

Now imagine carrying that weight not for a few days, but for **twelve years**.

📖 Appetizer – Twelve Years of Pain, Luke 8:42b–43a

“...But as he went, the multitudes pressed against him. ⁴³ A woman who had a flow of blood for twelve years...”

She had spent everything she had on physicians. No one could help her. Her body was weak, her money was gone, and her hope was hanging by a thread.

You’ve tried every YouTube remedy, every social media hack, every doctor, every urgent care, every “miracle” treatment and payment plan... and still no solution. Your resources are drained, and the situation hasn’t changed. That was the woman’s reality.

Imagine having a condition that silently drains you from the inside for over a decade. No clear answers. No lasting relief. Just ongoing pain, shame, and exhaustion.

Reflection:

Have you ever been in a season where you tried *everything* but still had to rely on faith for breakthrough?

Main Course – Faith That Reaches Out

Bite 1 – A Desperate Touch, Luke 8:43b–44

“...who had spent all her living on physicians and could not be healed by any, came behind him and touched the fringe of his cloak. Immediately the flow of her blood stopped.”

If you’ve ever been to a concert of a popular person, you know how thick the crowd is to just get close to the stage. ...She didn’t ask for the microphone, or a front-row seat, or a special audience. She just wanted to get close enough to **touch** Jesus—close enough to reach for the One everyone else was only crowding around.

Well, Jesus was on his way to heal a sick child, when she reached for the hem in a “risk-it-all” move. She wasn’t even supposed to be there.

Faith is often a desperate reach toward Jesus when you have nothing left to lose. Her faith pulled power directly from the Source, and that was the difference between the people who were there just to be there and a woman you refused to be denied wholeness (or a cure).

Thought:

How hard would it be to get close enough to touch a world leader or celebrity? Yet this woman pushed through every barrier—cultural, physical, emotional—to reach the King of kings.

Reflection:

Where in your life do you need that same “pressing through” kind of faith?

Bite 2 – “Who Touched Me?” Luke 8:45–47

⁴⁵ Jesus said, ‘Who touched me?’ When all denied it, Peter and those with him said, ‘Master, the multitudes press and jostle you, and you say, ‘Who touched me?’ ’ ⁴⁶ But Jesus said, ‘Someone did touch me, for I perceived that power has gone out of me.’ ⁴⁷ When the woman saw that she was not hidden, she came trembling, and falling down before him declared to him in the presence of all the people the reason why she had touched him, and how she was healed immediately.”

The crowd was pressing against Jesus, but **only one touch drew power**. Proximity is not the same as faith. Many bumped into Him, but only one believed *Him* for change for the issue that ailed her life.

□ CST:

Jesus felt the pull of faith. Power responded not to casual contact but to intentional belief. When the Holy Spirit meets genuine faith, something always shifts.

Reflection:

Recall a time when you had to “touch heaven”—a situation that drove you to seek God’s power above all else. What was happening, and how did that season change you?

Bite 3 – New Name, New Peace, Luke 8:48

He said to her, ‘Daughter, cheer up. Your faith has made you well. Go in peace.’

One sentence changed everything—her health, her status, and her identity. She was no longer “unclean woman”; she was **Daughter**.

Author’s Commentary

Her long struggle ended with a single word of affirmation from Jesus. When He calls you Daughter or Son, He doesn’t just fix your issue—He restores your place in the family. The Woman with the Issue of Blood is a story that many can relate to you having a problem and unfortunately making God or prayer your “last resort”, it’s like the dreaded red button under the glass that you do NOT want to push! Push - Pray Until Something Happens - let your faith connect with the Word and power of God. Nobody is saying don’t go to the doctor, but the message is about bringing your faith to the doctor’s office and bring your ISSUES to the altar.

So many of us have suffered in things for a long while, and Jesus is waiting on us to do our part and trust him with it. Break through the doubt, press through the challenges and arrive at the hem of God and the spiritual connection to the healing that was released when our Savior was tied and hung on a tree. Through an long term unclean messed up, messy situation - though her blood was filthy his Blood is cleansing and through it there is victory to everyone who is willing to accept all the benefits of being redeemed, hallelujah!

Dessert – Push Through the Crowd

Sometimes our faith becomes the “last resort,” but God invites us to make it our **first response**. The woman could have stayed home, stayed hidden, stayed hopeless—but she chose to move.

Like her, we are called to:

- Push through doubt.
- Push through fear.
- Push through shame.
- Push through the noise of the crowd...

...until we reach the hem of His garment.

Reflection:

What crowd—voices, opinions, fears, distractions—do you need to push through right now to get closer to Jesus?

To-Go Box

Her blood made her unclean.

His blood made her whole.

Through Christ’s sacrifice:

- We are redeemed, not rejected.
- We are restored, not ruined.
- We are cleansed, not canceled.
- No matter how long the struggle has lasted, **victory is still possible through His blood.**

Carry this with you:

When you reach for Jesus in faith, He always has more healing than you have hurt.

Prayer

“Lord Jesus, Thank You that Your blood still heals, restores, and makes us whole. Thank You for seeing us when we feel unseen, and for calling us ‘Daughter’ and ‘Son’ when the world calls us ‘unclean.’

Give us the courage to press through every crowd of fear, shame, or doubt to reach You. Teach us to make faith our first response, not our last resort. Where we are bleeding in our bodies, minds, or hearts, let Your healing power flow.

Fill us with Your peace as we walk forward in faith.

In Your mighty name, amen.”

Notes Section — Personal Study

Activity – Word Search Puzzle

Find each word from the Word Bank in the puzzle. Words may be hidden forwards, backwards, up, down, or diagonally.

T	A	B	U	D	K	B
B	W	T	N	K	J	R
I	I	E	C	Q	K	O
L	A	M	L	A	N	D
H	E	I	E	V	E	E
C	I	M	A	I	E	N
E	D	W	N	W	S	A
C	R	O	W	D	I	C
R	E	H	T	A	R	T
R	M	O	W	D	A	M
T	D	E	E	S	O	R
R	O	D	H	R	A	G
S	F	E	H	T	E	R
H	A	N	L	O	V	E
L	I	E	R	S	A	W
Y	T	M	A	H	N	O
T	H	N	O	H	T	P
P	A	L	I	E	V	T

WORD BANK UNCLEA, FAITH, HEM, POWER, HEAL, KNEES, CROWD, TWELVE, LOVE

Appendix – Breakfast Month 2 (AE) Answer Key

Theme: The Art of Through – Youth Edition

Lesson 1 – Joseph: The Young Dreamer

Activity – Fill in the Blank

1. Joseph's brothers sold him for _____ pieces of silver.
2. Joseph resisted the temptation of _____.
3. Pharaoh said Joseph was filled with the _____ of God.
4. Joseph's brothers bowed before him in _____.

Answer Key:

1. **Twenty (20)**
 2. **Potiphar's wife**
 3. The **Spirit** of God
 4. **Egypt**
-

Lesson 2 – Hannah: Barren but Not Lifeless

Activity – Word Scramble: Hannah's Hope

1. NNAHHA → **HANNAH**
2. ULSAME → **SAMUEL**
3. YERARP → **PRAYER**
4. THEFAI → **FAITH**

5. LIHEFSI → **HIS LIFE**

Fill in the Blank / Multiple Choice

1. Elkanah was married to _____.
 - Correct answer: **a. Hannah and Peninnah**
2. Elkanah and his wives would go to sacrifice in _____ at the Lord of _____.
 - Correct answer: **c. Shiloh, Heaven's Armies**
3. A vow is a _____.
 - Suggested key: **a serious promise or commitment made before God.**
4. Hannah promised to never _____.
 - Correct answer: **(b) Cut her child's hair** (reflecting the Nazirite-like vow regarding Samuel).
5. "Seeing her lips _____ but hearing no _____, he thought she had been _____."
 - Correct answer: **moving, sound, drinking**

Lesson 3 – Abram: No Heir, Wait Here

Activity – True or False: Trust the Timeline

1. Abram's faith never wavered from the start.
2. Sarai suggested a human solution to a divine promise.
3. God changed Abram's name after he demonstrated obedience.
4. Hagar's son was the covenant child.
5. God's timing tests faith before fulfilling it.

Answer Key:

1. **False** – He wrestled and questioned, even while believing.
 2. **True** – Sarai proposed using Hagar to "help" fulfill the promise.
 3. **True** – The name change comes as part of covenant confirmation after years of following.
 4. **False** – Isaac, not Ishmael, was the covenant child.
 5. **True** – Waiting often sharpens and proves our faith.
-

Lesson 4 – Victory Through the Blood

Activity – Crossword Puzzle

Letters that form the hidden words are **bolded** for easy reference.

T	A	B	U	D	K	B
B	W	T	N	K	J	R
I	I	E	C	Q	K	O
L	A	M	L	A	N	D
H	E	I	E	V	E	E
C	I	M	A	I	E	N
E	D	W	N	W	S	A
C	R	O	W	D	I	C
R	E	H	T	A	R	T
R	M	O	W	D	A	M
T	D	E	E	S	O	R
R	O	D	H	R	A	G
S	F	E	H	T	E	R
H	A	N	L	O	V	E
L	I	E	R	S	A	W
Y	T	M	A	H	N	O
T	H	N	O	H	T	P
P	A	L	I	E	V	T

SOUL FOOD BIBLE STUDY SERIES

Break · fast - Month 3

Adult Edition

 Theme:

Faith & Foresight

“⁶ In nothing be anxious, but in everything, by prayer and petition with thanksgiving, let your requests be made known to God. ”

— Phil4:6 (WEB)

Table of Contents

SOUL FOOD BIBLE STUDY SERIES.....	1
Faith & Foresight	1
Table of Contents.....	2
Introduction - Faith & Foresight	4
 Breakfast Edition Month 3 - Lesson 1: Rahab.....	5
Faith That Took Action	5
 Appetizer – The Risk That Changed Her Life, Josh 2:1, 3–4.....	5
 Main Course.....	6
 Bite 1 – The Risk That Redefined a Life, Josh 2:8–11a	6
 Bite 2 – When Faith Meets Action, Josh 2:12–14, 17–18.....	6
 Bite 3 – Faith That Rewrites the Future, Josh 6:22–23, 25 (<i>paraphrased</i>).....	7
 Dessert – Faith That Didn’t Wait, Hebrews 11:31.....	7
 Activity – True or False: Rahab’s Faith	9
 Author’s Testimony	9
 BM 3 – Lesson 2: Abigail	10
Wisdom on the Move.....	10
 Appetizer – The Courage to Step In, 1 Sam 25:18–20.....	10
 Main Course.....	11
 Bite 1 – Nabal’s Foolishness, 1 Sam 25:10–11, 14,17.....	11
 Bite 2 – Put the Blame on Me, 1 Sam 25:23–24, 28.....	11
 Bite 3 – A Wise Outcome, 1 Sam 25:32–35	12
 Dessert – When God Handles It, 1 Sam 25:38–39.....	13
 Activity – Fill in the Blank	14
 BM3 — Lesson 3: The Centurion	15
Faith That Commands Results.....	15
.....	15
 Appetizer – The Power of the Word, Matt 8:5–8.....	15
 Main Course.....	16
 Bite 1 – Faith That Understands Authority Matt 8:8–9a.....	16
 Bite 2 – Faith That Amazed Jesus, Matt 8:10, 13	16
 Author’s Commentary	16
 Bite 3 – The Sent Word, John 1:1,14	17

 Dessert – Beyond a Resume - A Word Is Enough	18
 Activity – Fill in the Blank	19
 BM3 — Lesson 4: Joseph of Arimathea	20
Trust the Process	20
 Appetizer – Faith in Action, John 19:38a; Matt 27:57–58	20
 Main Course – The Pivot.....	21
 Bite 1 Provision in Place, Matt 27:59–60	21
 Author's Commentary	21
 Bite 2 – Courage to Be Counted, John 19:38–39	21
 Bite 3 – Faith Sealed in Stone, John 19:40–42	22
 Author's Commentary	22
 To-Go Box	22
.....	23
 Activity – Connect the Process.....	23
	
Appendix – Breakfast Month 3 (AE) Answer Key	24
 Lesson 1 – Rahab: Faith That Took Action	24
 Lesson 2 – Abigail: Wisdom on the Move.....	24
 Lesson 3 – The Centurion: Faith That Commands Results	25
 Lesson 4 – Joseph of Arimathea: Trust the Process.....	25
CREDITS & ACKNOWLEDGEMENTS.....	26
..... <i>Back Cover: Why Soul Food? By Dr. D. Brown</i>	
.....	28

Introduction - *Faith & Foresight*

“Now faith is the substance of things hoped for, the evidence of things not seen.” — Hebrews 11:1 (KJV)



Faith and foresight are meant to walk hand-in-hand in our journey with God. Faith helps us trust what we cannot yet see, and foresight helps us prepare for what God has promised—even before He shows us all the details. Together, they invite us to follow God’s lead when the road ahead still looks uncertain.

Hebrews 11:1 tells us, “Now faith is confidence in what we hope for and assurance about what we do not see.” Faith lifts our eyes past the present moment and anchors our hearts in God’s truth instead of our changing circumstances. Foresight—spiritual insight shaped by God’s perspective—then guides the decisions we make today so they line up with what God is doing tomorrow.

Scripture gives us clear examples of people who lived with both faith and foresight. Noah built the ark long before the first raindrop fell (Genesis 6). Abraham obeyed God’s call and left home without knowing his destination (Hebrews 11:8). Joseph stored grain during years of abundance because he trusted God’s warning about the famine ahead (Genesis 41). Their lives show a consistent pattern: faith listens to God, and foresight gets ready for His plan.

In this study, we’ll see that walking with God takes more than belief—it takes vision grounded in faith. As we grow in spiritual foresight, we stop merely reacting to what’s happening around us and start responding to what God has spoken within us. Faith gives us the boldness to move forward; foresight helps us move with wisdom and purpose.



SOUL FOOD BIBLE STUDY (AE)



Breakfast Edition Month 3 - Lesson 1: Rahab

Faith That Took Action



Theme: Faith & Foresight



Background Text: Joshua 2:1–21; 6:22–25



Key Verse: Hebrews 11:31 (WEB)

“By faith, Rahab the prostitute didn’t perish with those who were disobedient, having received the spies in peace.”



Faith that acts before the promise is visible.



Appetizer – The Risk That Changed Her Life, Josh 2:1, 3–4

Joshua the son of Nun secretly sent two men out of Shittim as spies, saying, “Go, view the land, including Jericho.” They went and came into the house of a prostitute whose name was Rahab, and slept there.

³ Jericho’s king sent to Rahab, saying, “Bring out the men who have come to you, who have entered into your house; for they have come to spy out all the land. ⁴ The woman took the two men and hid them. Then she said, “Yes, the men came to me, but I didn’t know where they came from.

Rahab had to choose: stay safe with the crowd, or step out in risky obedience toward God. Her decision wasn’t just about her; it affected her whole family. She did not know the God of the Israelites but she knew of what he had done in and for His people and that was enough for her to regard them higher than her culture and her king.

Faith acted **before** the promise was visible. She chose courage in the face of death.



Reflection Question

Has your faith ever been tested in a way that demanded courage before you saw the results?

Main Course

Bite 1 – The Risk That Redefined a Life, Josh 2:8–11a

⁸ Before they had lain down, she came up to them on the roof. ⁹ She said to the men, “I know that Yahweh has given you the land, and that the fear of you has fallen upon us, and that all the inhabitants of the land melt away before you.

¹⁰ For we have heard how Yahweh dried up the water of the Red Sea before you, when you came out of Egypt; and what you did to the two kings of the Amorites, who were beyond the Jordan, to Sihon and to Og, whom you utterly destroyed. ¹¹ As soon as we had heard it, our hearts melted, and there wasn’t any more spirit in any man, because of you: for Yahweh your God, he is God

Faith comes by *hearing*—and Rahab proves it. She believed without ever seeing the Red Sea part or the Amorite kings fall. Testimonies of God’s power traveled farther than Israel’s feet, and those stories were enough to birth faith in her heart. Rahab wasn’t an Israelite. She didn’t grow up in church or know all the laws. But she heard what God had done—and believed it.

Her belief in a God she had never met was strong enough to inspire disobedience in danger. She feared (reverenced) God of Israel over man.

Reflection Questions

What’s one story (from the Bible or real life) that has strengthened your faith in God?

Bite 2 – When Faith Meets Action, Josh 2:12–14, 17-18

¹² Now therefore, please swear to me by Yahweh, since I have dealt kindly with you, that you also will deal kindly with my father’s house, and give me a true sign; ¹³ and that you will save alive my father, my mother, my brothers, and my sisters, and all that they have, and will deliver our lives from death.”

¹⁴ The men said to her, “Our life for yours, if you don’t talk about this business of ours; and it shall be, when Yahweh gives us the land, that we will deal kindly and truly with you.”

¹⁷ The men said to her, “We will be guiltless of this your oath which you’ve made us to swear.

¹⁸ Behold, when we come into the land, tie this line of scarlet thread in the window which you used to let us down. Gather to yourself into the house your father, your mother, your brothers, and all your father’s household.

Rahab’s temptation was the King and his men, her culture -instead of going with what she knew, she went with what was right. It wasn’t the popular choice, but it was a life changing one! Rahab didn’t just believe;

she made a covenant. The scarlet rope became a sign: when judgment came, her house would be marked by faith and spared.

Her faith wasn't passive; it was tied to **obedience**.

Reflection Question

What “scarlet rope” of obedience have you hung out as proof of your trust in God?

Bite 3 – Faith That Rewrites the Future, Josh 6:22–23, 25 (*paraphrased*)

²²Joshua said... “Go into the prostitute’s house, and bring out from there the woman, and all that she has, as you swore to her.” ²⁴So the young men... brought out Rahab, her father, her mother, her brothers, and all that she had... ²⁵ Joshua saved Rahab... and she lives in the middle of Israel to this day...

Rahab’s faith saved her whole household. While we could be tempted to ‘park it right there’ ...on the fact that she made sure her whole family benefited and avoided selfish acts...her story doesn’t stop but transitions from there! Later, she would be included in the family line that led to Jesus. Not bad for someone everyone else would have written off.

Faith not only *saves*—it *transforms*. Rahab went from outcast to insider, from pagan prostitute to part of God’s covenant people, and eventually into the family line of the Messiah Himself. Sometimes, the least likely person carries the greatest impact.

Reflection Question

Who might be saved, inspired, or transformed by **your** act of faith today?

Dessert – Faith That Didn’t Wait, Hebrews 11:31

“By faith, Rahab the prostitute didn’t perish with those who were disobedient, having received the spies in peace.”

Rahab could’ve waited until things were safer, clearer, or more convenient-but procrastination had one problem-there was no guarantee. Instead, she moved when God gave her the chance. There is no perfect or “good” or “ideal” time to accept salvation, the best time is NOW.

God didn’t highlight Rahab’s past to shame her but to magnify His grace. Her label didn’t stop her legacy. Faith rewrote her ending—and it can rewrite yours too.

Reflection:

Write one sentence of gratitude to God for giving you a future that's bigger than your past:

To-Go Box

- Faith hears what God has done and believes what He *will* do.
- Rahab's courage shows that obedience in a single moment can shift an entire family's destiny.
- Your history does not disqualify you; your response to God's invitation defines you.

Carry this truth:

Faith acts first; foresight trusts God with the outcome.

Don't let fear of judgment, failure, or your past silence your obedience. Like Rahab, your courage today can redeem generations tomorrow.

Word Study

- **Rahab / Rachab (Hebrew: רַחַב)** – “Spacious, broad.” Symbolic of enlargement and room made through faith.
- **Scarlet Rope** – A sign of covenant and protection, echoing the Passover blood on the doorposts and pointing forward to the blood of Christ.
- **Foresight** – Spiritual anticipation rooted in trust that God is already working beyond what we see.

Activity – True or False: Rahab’s Faith

1. Rahab was born an Israelite woman.
2. The scarlet rope represented obedience and covenant.
3. Rahab acted only out of fear, not faith.
4. Rahab’s faith saved her entire family.
5. Rahab later appeared in Jesus’ family line.

(Check answers in the Appendix)

Author’s Testimony

I once faced my own test of faith. I needed funds to remodel a home for veterans in need. Quotes came in as high as \$30,000, and my account was empty. But I prayed, “Lord, You know my needs, Jehovah-Jireh, my provider.” Within a week, God sent two unexpected renters who paid exactly \$12,000—the remaining amount I needed to complete the work.

Faith made a way I could not see. Like Rahab, I learned that obedience, no matter how small, can open doors for God’s miraculous provision. *Father, help each reader to boldly break away from things that are holding them back and embrace the opportunities to grow in your and walk into their purpose, in Jesus name amen.* 🙏

Notes Page — Group Discussion & Personal Study

BM 3 – Lesson 2: Abigail

Wisdom on the Move



Theme: Faith & Foresight



Background Text: 1 Sam 25:2–39; Prov 15:1



Key Verse: Proverbs 15:1

“A gentle answer turns away wrath, but a harsh word stirs up anger.”



Wisdom in motion: faith that chooses peace over pride.



Appetizer – The Courage to Step In, 1 Sam 25:18–20

¹⁸ Then Abigail hurried and took two hundred loaves of bread, two containers of wine, five sheep ready dressed, five seahs^[a] of parched grain, one hundred clusters of raisins, and two hundred cakes of figs, and laid them on donkeys. ¹⁹ She said to her young men, “Go on before me. Behold, I am coming after you.” But she didn’t tell her husband, Nabal. ²⁰ As she rode on her donkey, and came down hidden by the mountain, behold, David and his men came down toward her, and she met them.

David was angry because Nabal had insulted him and refused to help. Recognizing how foul her husband behaved, Abigail stepped in quickly to bring food, humility, and peace before things got violent.

Abigail wasted no time. She quickly gathered two hundred loaves of bread, two containers of wine, five prepared sheep, roasted grain, clusters of raisins, and cakes of figs. She packed them on donkeys and said to her servants, “Go on ahead. I will follow you shortly.” But she didn’t tell her husband Nabal what she was doing. Sometimes moving strategically is moving stealthily!



Reflection Question

When was the last time you acted on faith to prevent harm or conflict?

Main Course

Bite 1 – Nabal’s Foolishness, 1 Sam 25:10–11, 14,17

¹⁰ Nabal answered David’s servants and said, “Who is David? Who is the son of Jesse? There are many servants who break away from their masters these days. ¹¹ Shall I then take my bread, my water, and my meat that I have killed for my shearers, and give it to men who I don’t know where they come from?”

¹⁴ But one of the young men told Abigail, Nabal’s wife, saying, “Behold, David sent messengers out of the wilderness to greet our master; and he insulted them. ¹⁷ Now therefore know and consider what you will do; for evil is determined against our master and against all his house, for he is such a worthless fellow that one can’t speak to him.”

Later, one of Nabal’s servants told Abigail how David’s men had been good to them in the fields, how they had not been harmed or stolen from, and yet Nabal “rushed on them” with insults. He warned her that disaster was hanging over the household because Nabal was such a worthless man “that one can’t speak to him”

CST

Nabal’s arrogance created a crisis. Foolish pride will always test someone’s faith. Abigail’s faith met that test with wisdom, not words of war. The bible says in James 1:19-20 (KJV, paraphrased), that we should be ‘quick to listen, slow to speak and slow to wrath. Because the wrath of man doesn’t produce the righteousness of God. Nabal wasn’t trying to hear anyone of reason and sometimes we hear through emotional filters, and it is important for us to identify and call out these barriers to the truth, just like Nabal’s servants did to Abigail.

Reflection Question

Have you ever had to respond to someone’s anger or disrespect with peace instead of pride?

Bite 2 – Put the Blame on Me, 1 Sam 25:23-24, 28

²³ When Abigail saw David, she hurried and got off her donkey, and fell before David on her face and bowed herself to the ground. ²⁴ She fell at his feet and said, “On me, my lord, on me be the blame! Please let your servant speak in your ears. Hear the words of your servant.

²⁸ Please forgive the trespass of your servant. For Yahweh will certainly make my lord a sure house, because my lord fights Yahweh’s battles. Evil will not be found in you all your days.

She strategically pointed David back to God’s promise over his life—that Yahweh would surely make him ruler over Israel. She urged him not to carry needless bloodshed or vengeance on his record when that day

came. Abigail took on the blame for her husband's offense—an act of courage and foresight. She spoke life into David's calling instead of fueling his wrath. Her humility redirected the entire situation.

"Standing in the gap isn't about being a doormat; it's about being a shock absorber. It means you care more about God's honor and keeping people safe than about winning a petty argument. An 'Abigail move' can literally save a life—I know because it happened to me.

Reflection Questions

- What does it mean to “stand in the gap” for someone else's mistake?

- Have you ever had to de-escalate a situation you didn't cause?

- Did your response bring God honor or dishonor?

Bite 3 – A Wise Outcome, 1 Sam 25:32–35

³² David said to Abigail, “Blessed is Yahweh, the God of Israel, who sent you today to meet me! ³³ Blessed is your discretion, and blessed are you, who have kept me today from blood guiltiness, and from avenging myself with my own hand.

³⁵ So David received from her hand that which she had brought him. Then he said to her, “Go up in peace to your house. Behold, I have listened to your voice and have granted your request.”

David calmed down. The fight stopped before it ever started. Abigail's actions saved her household and kept David from making a choice he'd regret. Hallelujah, praise the Lord he listened to reason.

One act of wisdom can save an entire household. Faith foresaw danger; wisdom found peace. Abigail's actions honored God, David, and her own integrity.

Reflection Question

What would the world look like if more of us prayed for wisdom before reacting?

Dessert – When God Handles It, 1 Sam 25:38–39

³⁸ About ten days later, Yahweh struck Nabal, so that he died. ³⁹ When David heard that Nabal was dead, he said, “Blessed is Yahweh, who has pleaded the cause of my reproach from the hand of Nabal, and has kept back his servant from evil. Yahweh has returned the evildoing of Nabal on his own head.”

About ten days later, the Lord struck Nabal, and he died. When David heard that Nabal was dead, he said, “Praise the Lord, who has avenged the insult I received from Nabal and has kept me from doing it myself.” Then David sent messengers to propose marriage to Abigail.

When God vindicates, He also elevates. Abigail’s humility brought her favor—she went from the wife of a fool to the bride of a future king.

To-Go Box

- Faith and foresight are more than belief—they are wisdom in motion.
- Pride creates unnecessary battles; humility opens unexpected doors.
- When we humble ourselves and act with discernment, God can turn conflict into protection and even promotion.

Closing Prayer (Abigail – Wisdom on the Move)

“Lord, thank You for Abigail’s example of wisdom and courage. Help me respond with grace when other people’s foolishness creates messes around me. Teach me to honor You, treat Your people well, and trust You to handle what I can’t. In Jesus’ name, amen.



Personal Prayer Space

Write your own reflection or prayer to God about trusting His Word and His authority in your life:



Word Study

- **Abigail (Hebrew: אֲבִיגַיִל – “Avigayil”)** — “My father’s joy” or “source of joy.” Her character embodied the beauty of her name; she became a channel of peace and joy even in chaos.
- **Nabal (Hebrew: נָבָל – “Nabal”)** — “Foolish” or “senseless.” His actions reflected his name, showing how arrogance blinds us to wisdom and leads to destruction.
- **Scapegoat (Hebrew: עֲזָזָאֵל – “Azazel”)** — From Leviticus 16, referring to the goat released into the wilderness carrying the sins of the people. Symbolically, Abigail bore the “guilt” of her household to intercede for peace.
- **Foresight** — Spiritual sensitivity that anticipates and prepares for what God is revealing ahead of time.

Write one line about where you need *foresight* right now:



Activity – Fill in the Blank

1. Abigail acted with _____ and faith, not fear.
2. Nabal’s pride led to his _____.
3. David praised God for Abigail’s _____.
4. Abigail’s wisdom prevented _____ and brought peace.

(Check answers in the Appendix)

BM3 — Lesson 3: The Centurion

Faith That Commands Results



Theme: Trusting Jesus' Word



Background Text: Matt 8:5–13; Luke 7:1–10



Key Verse: Matt 8:10 (WEB)

“When Jesus heard it, he marveled, and said... ‘Most certainly I tell you, I haven’t found so great a faith, not even in Israel.’”



Faith that trusts the Word, not the circumstances.



Appetizer – The Power of the Word, Matt 8:5–8

⁵ When he came into Capernaum, a centurion came to him, asking him for help, ⁶ saying, “Lord, my servant lies in the house paralyzed, grievously tormented.” ⁷ Jesus said to him, “**I will come and heal him.**” The centurion answered, ‘Lord, I’m not worthy for you to come under my roof. Just say the word, and my servant will be healed.’

The centurion didn’t ask Jesus for a visit—he asked Him for a word. He believed that one word from Jesus could travel farther and work faster than any doctor, medicine, or ritual.

Faith is not about proximity—it’s about posture. The centurion knew Jesus didn’t have to be physically present to be powerfully effective. True belief doesn’t demand evidence; it simply trusts the Word.



Reflection Question

Have you ever believed God for something without needing to “see” how He would do it?

Main Course

Bite 1 – Faith That Understands Authority Matt 8:8–9a

The centurion answered, “Lord, I’m not worthy for you to come under my roof. Just say the word, and my servant will be healed. For I also am a man under authority, having under myself soldiers. I tell this one, ‘Go,’ and he goes...”

He didn’t need Jesus to walk to his house. He understood that if Jesus had authority, then His word was enough—even from a distance. Real faith doesn’t always need a physical sign. It trusts that when Jesus speaks, it’s already done.

CST Thought

Humility is the bridge to divine help. The centurion had status, money, and influence—but he laid all of that down at Jesus’ feet. Faith is strongest when pride is silent.

Reflection Question

How does humility open the door for faith to operate in your life?

Bite 2 – Faith That Amazed Jesus, Matt 8:10, 13

¹⁰ When Jesus heard it, he marveled and said to those who followed, “Most certainly I tell you, I haven’t found so great a faith, not even in Israel. ¹³ Jesus said to the centurion, “Go your way. Let it be done for you as you have believed.” His servant was healed in that hour.

When he looked at Jesus, he recognized heavenly authority at work: the same power that governs sickness, distance, and timing. Jesus was amazed at this man’s faith. Not because he was perfect or religious, but because he believed Jesus’ word was enough.

Author’s Commentary

Your background doesn’t limit your faith. Jesus is moved by trust, not titles. Aligning with the Great “I AM” starts with your words. Think about it: in the very first chapter of the Bible, the Creator didn’t use hands or tools to build the universe—He spoke ten times, and reality shifted.

Proverbs 18:21 tells us that life and death are held in the power of the tongue, and Isaiah 55:11 explains the authority behind that release. The Centurion understood the assignment. He knew that while "laying on of hands" might make people feel better, the real work happens when a word is released. He didn't need a ritual; he just needed a command. That word ricochets through eternity until it hits the target.

In the modern world, we say "Say Less"—because when you are walking in strong faith, you don't need a long speech. That level of trust was the "IT" factor that turned his request into a power move.

He believed that if Jesus spoke, creation itself had to respond. He saw that Jesus carried a higher command than Rome—kingdom authority.

Reflection Question

When you pray, do you believe the words you speak *in Jesus' name* carry that same delegated authority?

Bite 3 – The Sent Word, John 1:1,14

1 In the beginning was the Word, and the Word was with God, and the Word was God. ¹⁴ And the Word was made flesh, and dwelt among us, (and we beheld his glory, the glory as of the only begotten of the Father,) full of grace and truth.

The centurion had many reasons why he didn't believe Jesus needed to physically come, but Emmanuel, was happy someone caught the revelation. When he sent the word, he sent HIMSELF, because he was and is the Word! Whew...

He sent grace, and the truth that he was a healer, and a provider. In the past we use to send notes or mail by men on horseback, or by train... Now we have devices that allow us to send our thoughts via recorded files or text across oceans and time zones. They did not have electricity and the internet but they had faith and the Son of God walking with them...who was God's word wrapped in clay. Since he is wholeness and healing ...he just released it with his servant's recovery in mind... and in an hour he was well again!

Reflection Question

Who could you be praying for or believing for, like the centurion did for his servant?

Dessert – Beyond a Resume - A Word Is Enough

Jesus didn't respond to the wealth, the power, or the "good guy" resume. He responded to a heart in need. Emmanuel—God with us—met a level of faith that understood Christ's authority isn't limited by physical presence. The Centurion knew that the Will and the Word of God were enough to cross any threshold and restore what was broken.

When we say "Amen," we are literally saying **"It is so."** It's the moment we stop looking for a physical sign and come into total agreement with what God has already spoken. The Centurion didn't need a visit; he just needed a Word. He knew that once the Word was released, the shift was already final.

What would shift in your prayer life if you trusted what God said more than what you see?

To-Go Box

- Faith and foresight together teach us that authority in prayer isn't about volume or visibility—it's about confidence in the Word of God.
 - Humility positions us to receive what pride would block.
 - Real faith does not require God to "prove it" first; it rests in what He has already spoken.
 - When you recognize Jesus' authority, you can walk in your own God-given authority with boldness and peace.
-

Prayer

"Lord Jesus, thank You for the centurion's example of simple, strong faith. Help me to trust Your Word more than what I see and to pray with confidence in Your authority, not my own strength. Teach me to stay humble, to believe that when You speak, things change. In Your name, amen."



Word Study

- **Centurion (Latin: *Centurio*)** – A Roman officer over about one hundred soldiers; represents leadership through discipline, obedience, and order.
- **Authority (Greek: *Exousia*, ἐξουσία)** – Permission and delegated power; the right to act. Jesus carries authority over nature, sickness, sin, and even death.
- **Faith (Greek: *Pistis*, πίστις)** – Trust, conviction, and complete reliance upon God’s truth and character.

Write a short line about where you need to trust Jesus’ authority more fully:



Activity – Fill in the Blank

1. The centurion’s faith worked even at a _____.
2. Jesus said, “I have not found anyone in Israel with such great _____.”
3. True faith doesn’t need evidence; it trusts the _____.
4. The centurion understood the power of _____.

(Check the Appendix for answers)

BM3 — Lesson 4: Joseph of Arimathea

Trust the Process



Theme: Faith & Foresight



Background Text : Matthew 27:57–61; John 19:38–42



Key Verse: John 19:38 (WEB)

“After these things, Joseph of Arimathea, being a disciple of Jesus, but secretly for fear of the Jews, asked of Pilate that he might take away Jesus’ body. Pilate gave him permission. He came therefore and took away his body.”

 *Faith that honors Jesus even when the story looks finished.*



Appetizer – Faith in Action, John 19:38a; Matt 27:57–58

³⁸ After these things, Joseph of Arimathaea, being a disciple of Jesus, but secretly for fear of the Jews,

⁵⁷ When the even was come, there came a rich man of Arimathaea, named Joseph, who also himself was Jesus' disciple: ⁵⁸ He went to Pilate, and begged the body of Jesus. Then Pilate commanded the body to be delivered

Joseph of Arimathea was a rich man, a respected council member, and a quiet follower of Jesus. When many had run away in fear, he stepped forward in love and courage. He went straight to Pilate and asked for the body of the crucified Christ—a bold, risky request that publicly tied his name to Jesus at the very moment things looked the worst.

Even in loss, faith moves us to act in honor. Joseph’s decision to claim Jesus’ body was not loud or flashy, but it was a quiet and powerful display of devotion when many others had fled.



Reflection Question

When have you had to act on your faith quietly but boldly, even when others were afraid to stand?



Main Course – The Pivot



Bite 1 Provision in Place, Matt 27:59–60

⁵⁹Joseph took the body and wrapped it in a clean linen cloth ⁶⁰and laid it in his own new tomb, which he had cut out in the rock. Then he rolled a large stone against the door of the tomb, and departed.

Joseph used what he had already prepared for himself—a new tomb carved in the rock—to honor Jesus. He wrapped the Lord’s body carefully, placed Him in that tomb, and sealed it with a great stone. What Joseph once thought was for his future became part of God’s bigger plan.

God’s provision is never late. Long before Jesus’ crucifixion, the Father had already chosen and prepared Joseph to meet this moment. What looked like a personal investment (a private tomb) became a kingdom assignment.



Author’s Commentary

It wasn’t just a believer who requested the body of Jesus, but Joseph of Arimathea—a wealthy man and quiet follower of Christ. He didn’t realize that the tomb he built for himself would one day hold the body of the Savior of the world. His influence and position on the council gave him access to Pilate, and because of that, the king granted his request for the body. God had already provided everything needed from Christ’s birth to His burial. All we must do is trust the process.

Sometimes the Lord will place you in a role, job, or position you don’t fully understand—not for your comfort, but for His assignment.



Reflection Question

Is there something God has called you to do that you don’t yet understand? Are you willing to trust the process while your faith grows?



Bite 2 – Courage to Be Counted, John 19:38–39

³⁸After these things, Joseph of Arimathea, being a disciple of Jesus, but secretly for fear of the Jews, asked of Pilate that he might take away Jesus’ body. Pilate gave him permission. He came therefore and took away his body. ³⁹Nicodemus, who at first came to Jesus by night, also came bringing a mixture of myrrh and aloes, about a hundred Roman pounds

Joseph had been a *secret* disciple, afraid of what the Jewish leaders might say. But at the cross, his secret faith became public action. Nicodemus, who once came to Jesus at night, joined him in this bold, costly act of honor. Both men stepped out of the shadows to align themselves with a “condemned” Messiah.

There comes a time when quiet belief must become visible obedience. Faith that stays hidden forever never fully walks in purpose. Joseph and Nicodemus show us that even if you started secretly, God can still call you to stand boldly.

Bite 3 – Faith Sealed in Stone, John 19:40–42

So they took Jesus’ body, and bound it in linen cloths with the spices, as the custom of the Jews is to bury. Now in the place where he was crucified there was a garden. In the garden was a new tomb in which no man had ever yet been laid. Then because of the Jews’ Preparation Day (for the tomb was near at hand) they laid Jesus there.

Everything about this scene looked final: the spices, the linen, the new tomb, the stone. Yet heaven knew this was not the end—it was a setup. The garden tomb was not a permanent resting place; it was the stage for resurrection.

When you trust God’s process, even what looks like a burial can become the birthplace of breakthrough. What we call “the end” may be where God is just getting started.

Author’s Commentary

Sometimes the prompt feels “silly,” but obedience is the key to a chain of events only God can see. While stationed in Guantanamo Bay, Cuba, I felt a sudden urge at the altar to hug and speak life to a sister who was hurting. In my head, it felt random, but I chose to move anyway.

I didn’t know that another woman in the service, Sister Williams, had just challenged God for a sign that He was still listening. She actually had a vision of me hugging that sister before I even stood up. Because I didn’t let my “lack of action” get in the way, a chain reaction happened: the sister at the altar received comfort, and Williams received the divine confirmation she desperately needed. One “silly” step of faith can be the answer to someone else’s secret prayer.

To-Go Box

- Faith and foresight remind us that obedience opens doors long before we know we’ll need to walk through them.
- God often uses our resources, positions, and plans for purposes bigger than we imagined.
- Trust that God’s plans are already in motion—even when you can’t see the full picture yet.
- Like Joseph of Arimathea, your quiet preparation today may be part of a major move of God tomorrow.

Closing Prayer

“Lord, thank You for Joseph of Arimathea’s example of quiet, courageous faith. Help me to trust Your process, even when I don’t understand every step. Use what I have and where I am for Your purpose, not just my plans. In Jesus’ name, amen.”

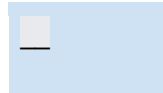
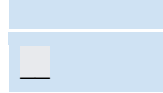
Word Study

- **Arimathea** – A town near Jerusalem; the name is associated with “heights” or a high place.
- **Joseph (Hebrew: *Yosef*)** – “He will add” or “He increases” — prophetic of increase and multiplication.
- **Trust (Hebrew: *Batach*)** – To rely on, be confident, or secure; a firm confidence in God’s provision and timing.

Write a short line about where you need to *batach*—to lean hard into trusting God’s process:

Activity – Connect the Process

Match each act of faith (left) with the result (right).

Match	Activity	Phrase
	1 Joseph’s request for Jesus’ body	A The burial fulfilled prophecy with reverence.
	2 Wrapping Jesus in linen	B A temporary seal that set up resurrection
	3 Building his own tomb	C Jesus’ body was placed in a tomb of honor.
	4 Rolling the stone	D God used a personal plan for divine purpose

Appendix – Breakfast Month 3 (AE) Answer Key

Theme: Faith & Foresight – Youth Edition

Lesson 1 – Rahab: Faith That Took Action

Activity – True or False: Rahab’s Faith

1. Rahab was an Israelite woman raised in a godly home.
➤ False – She was a Canaanite woman from Jericho.
2. The scarlet rope was a sign of the agreement between Rahab and the spies.
➤ True
3. Rahab’s actions showed both faith in God and concern for her family.
➤ True
4. Rahab’s faith only affected her, not anyone else.
➤ False – Her whole household was saved.
5. Rahab is later mentioned in the family line of Jesus.
➤ True – She appears in His genealogy.

Lesson 2 – Abigail: Wisdom on the Move

Activity – Fill in the Blank

1. Abigail acted with **wisdom** and faith, not fear.
 2. Nabal’s pride led to his **death**.
 3. David praised God for Abigail’s **good sense/wisdom**.
 4. Abigail’s wisdom prevented **bloodshed/killing** and brought peace.
-

Lesson 3 – The Centurion: Faith That Commands Results

Activity – Fill in the Blank

1. The centurion's faith worked even at a distance.
 2. Jesus said, "I have not found anyone in Israel with such great faith."
 3. True faith doesn't need evidence; it trusts the Word.
 4. The centurion understood the power of authority.
-

Lesson 4 – Joseph of Arimathea: Trust the Process

Activity – Connect the Process

Match each act of faith with the correct result:

- 1 Joseph's request for Jesus' body → **Jesus' body was placed in a tomb of honor.**
- 2 Building his own tomb → **God used a personal plan for divine purpose.**
- 3 Wrapping Jesus in linen → **The burial fulfilled prophecy with reverence.**
- 4 Rolling the stone → **A temporary seal that set up resurrection power.**

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Reference & Study Resources

Historical, linguistic, and cultural insights for the instructors and teachers- extended study materials have been formed by standard biblical reference works, concordances, and reputable academic sources, as outlined in the Reference & Historical Source Index (Instructor Edition) for this series. These tools were used under educational Fair Use to provide context, clarity, and enrichment for teachers and students alike.

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Special thanks to the emerging world of FaithTech and “greater works” digital tools that helped make this project possible at a fraction of the traditional cost, multiplying reach while honoring the message of the Gospel.

Above all, I give glory to God for every person, prayer, tool, and resource that has helped turn Soul Food from a vision into a living, teaching ministry on the page.

Why Soul Food?



Dr. Dee Brown,
Soul Series Founder

Growing up in Boston, my grandmother, Pastor Pearl Doctor, always brought both the food and the Word to the table. You couldn't walk into her home without smelling something cooking and hearing something spiritual on the radio. Whether you came in upset, excited, nervous, or afraid, she would bring you back to center—with the Word of God in one hand and a plate of food in the other.

She didn't wait until Sunday to offer support. She lived what I now call ***"Truth Served Daily"***—sharing God's Word like heavenly bread alongside whatever she had on the stove. I watched family and friends find peace in that kind of soul food, the kind that nourishes the inner person and prepares us for more than the moment we're in.

This **Soul Food Break*Fast Instructor Edition** was born from that legacy. Designed for teachers, facilitators, and ministry leaders in Bible study circles, cell groups, and Sunday school settings, each lesson offers bite-sized, life-giving "courses" to help your class lay a strong foundation in Christ, deepen fellowship, and share what God is doing in them with others.

The Instructor Edition adds extra tools to support you as you lead: helpful historical notes, dual Scripture references, guidance for activity answers and review material, and tips for navigating "check points" or conversation starters so discussion doesn't stall but moves into the depth and height of biblical truth. It's built to help you direct wholesome, engaging lessons that can be completed in about 75–90 minutes.

Based on the class demographic you're serving, you can pair this Instructor Edition with the matching Soul Food Break*Fast workbook. With the purchase of this paperback, you also receive one free eBook, giving you a comprehensive view of the study as you prepare.

My hope is that these pages bring comfort, clarity, and courage—and inspire you to pass that soul food along.

Be Blessed!



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